Survey walkthrough

The five confirmatory surveys, screen by screen

This document shows every distinct screen of the five confirmatory human surveys as a participant sees it: the consent page, the instructions, the attention check, each type of choice page in numbers, words and pictures, the two demographic questions, the last page, and the two pages shown when a participant stops early. The surveys have no comprehension questions; the attention check is the only check question.

Each screen was rendered on September 29, 2026 from the five survey files (backbone.qsf, survey2_sim.qsf, survey3_words.qsf, survey3_pictures.qsf, survey4_pricefree.qsf). The page text, the choice cards and the code that draws them are taken unchanged from the files; each choice page is filled with a real participant script from that survey's balanced set; and the page runs in a web browser inside a frame that copies the Qualtrics layout. The files match the surveys held in Qualtrics exactly, apart from fields Qualtrics assigns on import.

Two things are placeholders on purpose until the approved launch after Stage 1 acceptance: the consent text (the bracketed note on the consent page) and the Prolific completion code (REPLACE_COMPLETION_CODE). A survey cannot be fielded by accident while they stand.

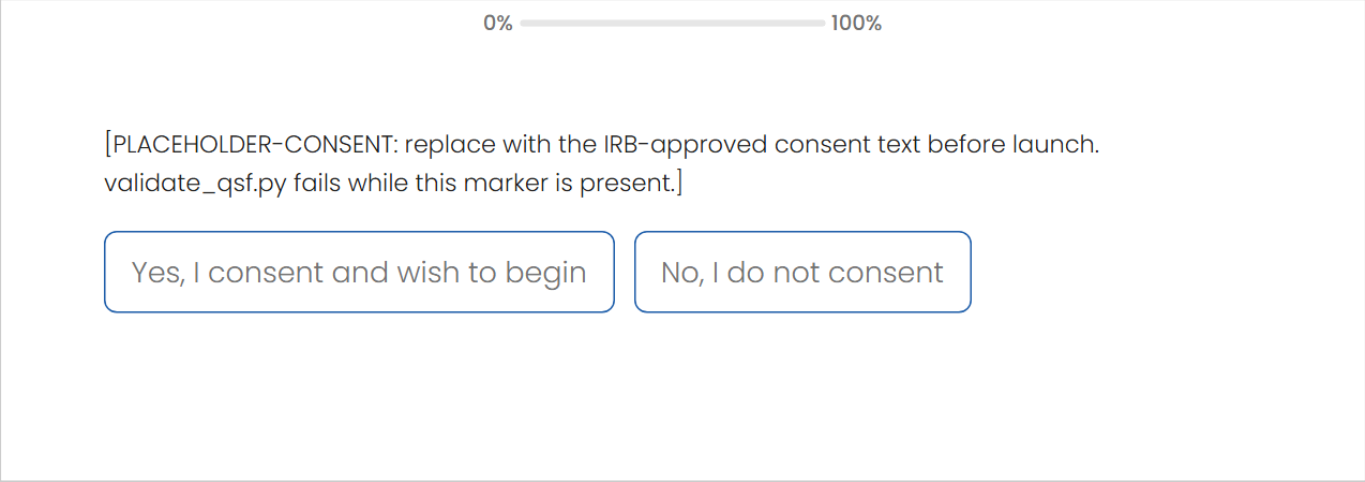
The option order on each page is the order dealt to that script. It varies across participants, except in the pictures version, where it is the order drawn in the picture. Nothing is selected in these screenshots: on the consent page and on every choice page the arrow that moves to the next page appears only after the participant makes a selection. Each screenshot is cropped to the survey's content column, from the progress bar to just below the last element on the page.

Contents

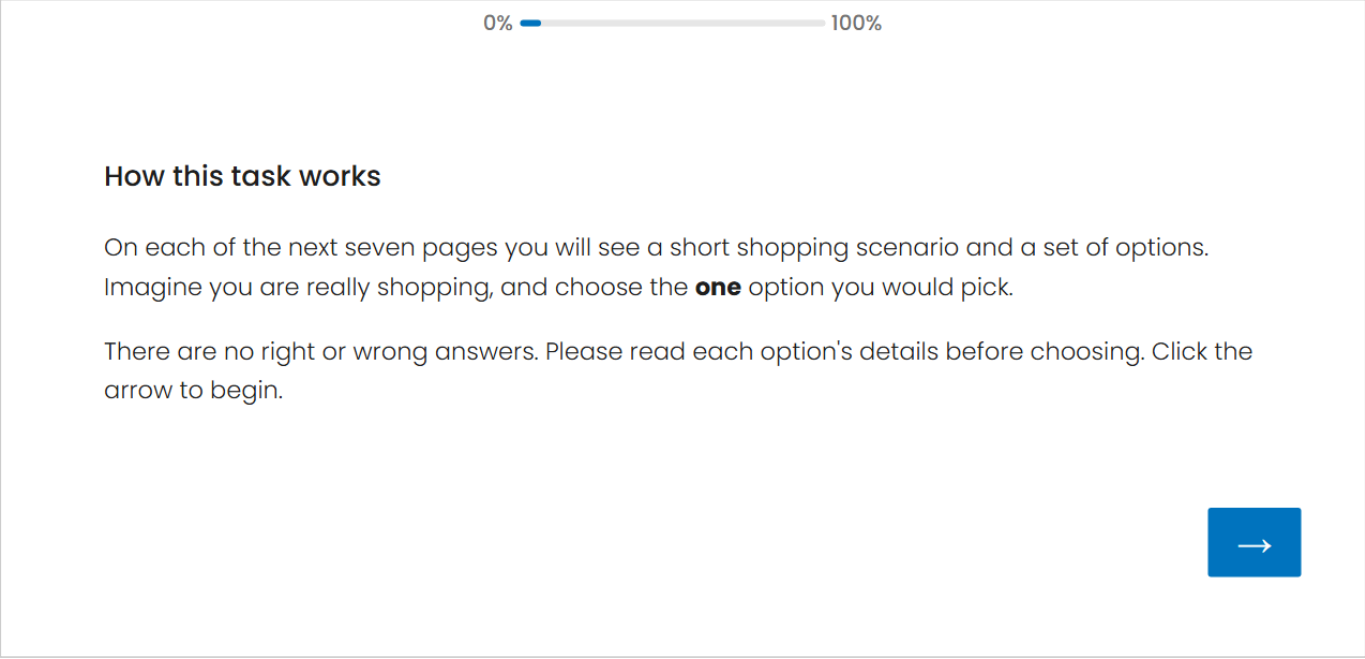
Survey 1: numeric survey 2
Survey 2: similarity survey 17
Survey 3, words version 20
Survey 3, pictures version 23
Survey 4: price-free survey 26
Pages shown only when a participant stops early 30

Survey 1: numeric survey

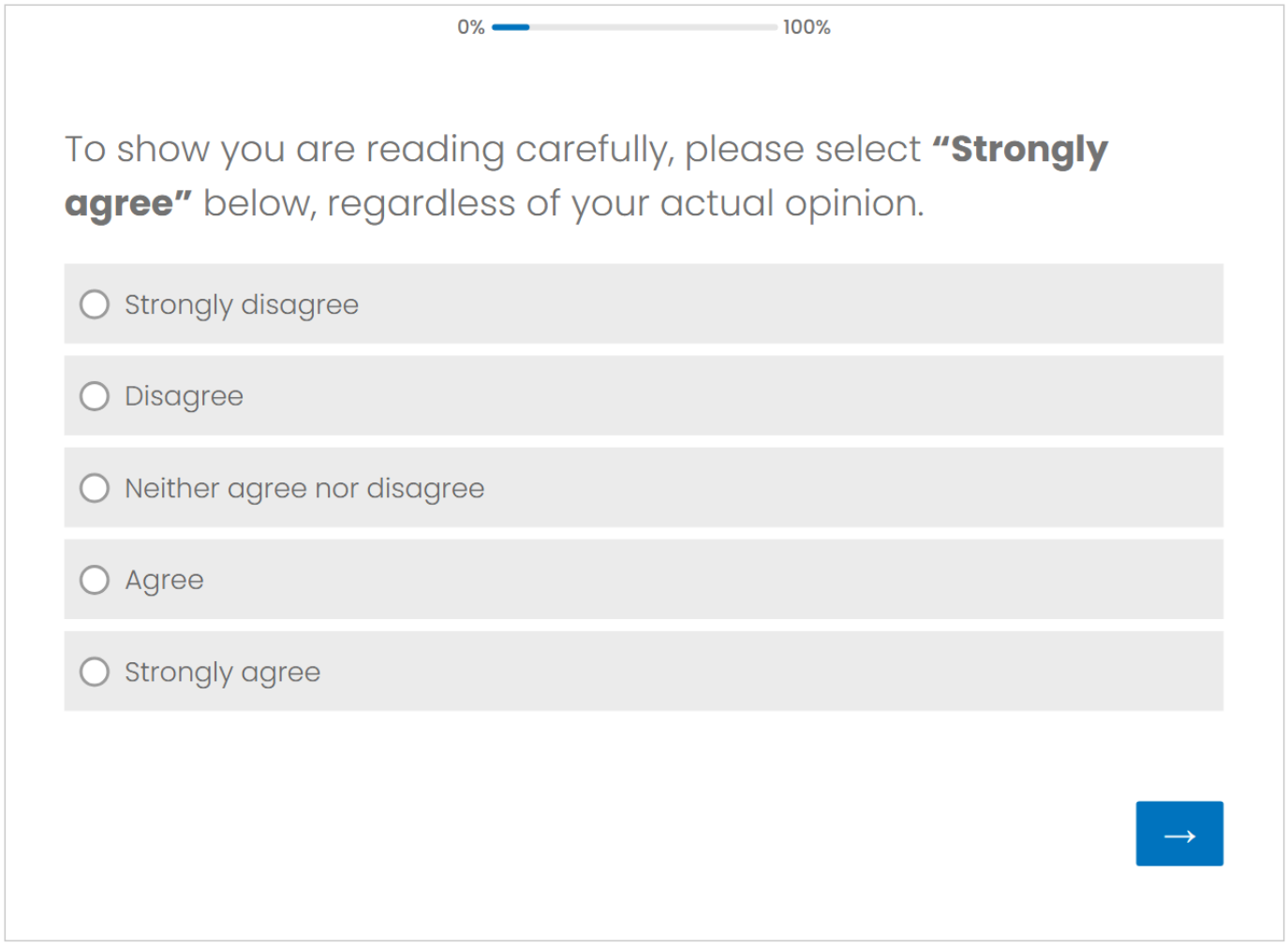
About 9,000 participants make seven choices each, all shown with numbers. Each participant is dealt one of 180 pre-built balanced scripts, so every participant sees seven different categories and seven different page types. One page of each of the nine page types is shown, from the new-values tier, followed by one page from the published-values tier and one from the invented-category tier.



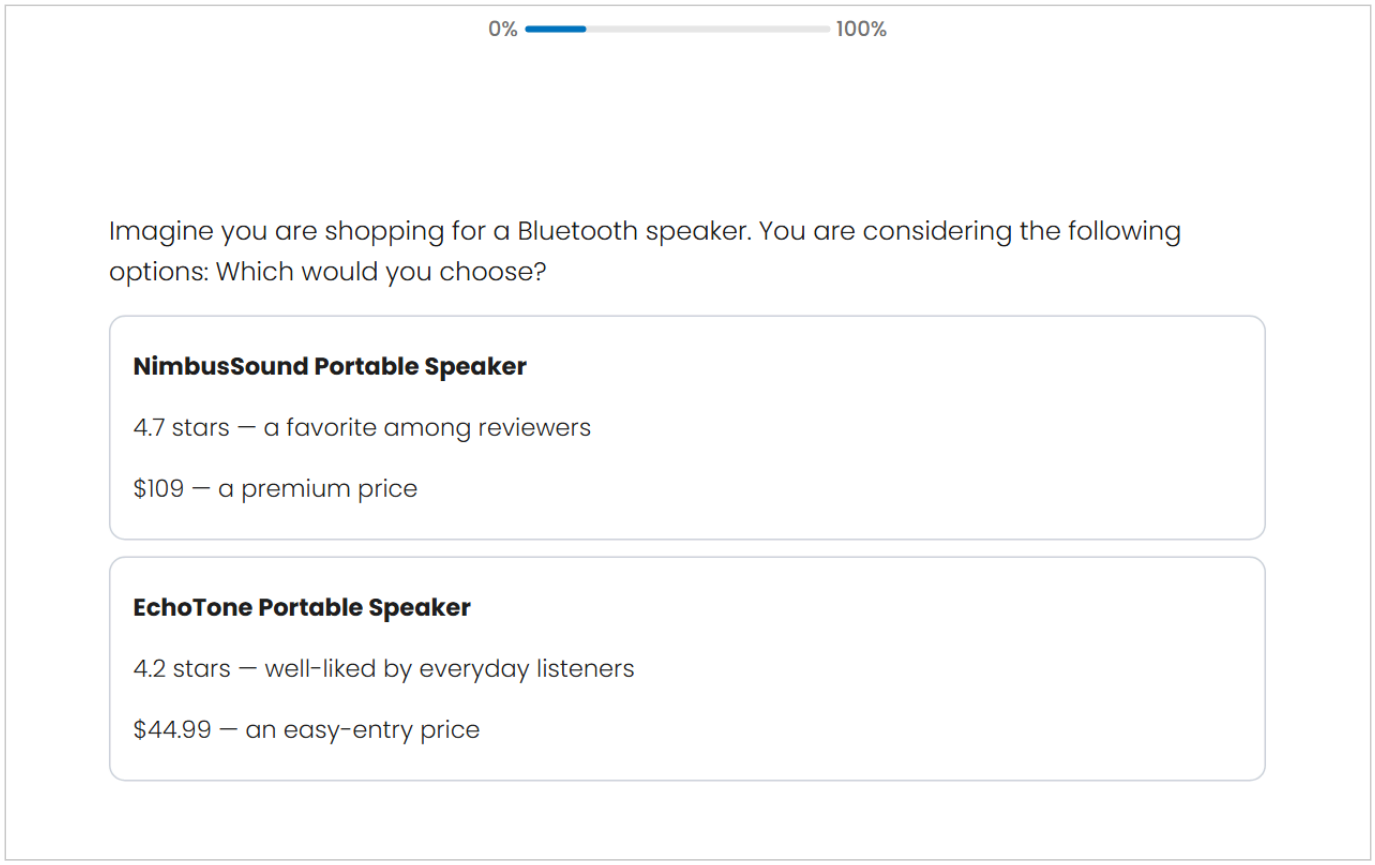
The consent page. The bracketed text is a placeholder that is replaced with the approved consent text at launch; the arrow appears only after the participant clicks one of the two buttons. A participant who does not consent goes straight to the end page shown in the last section.



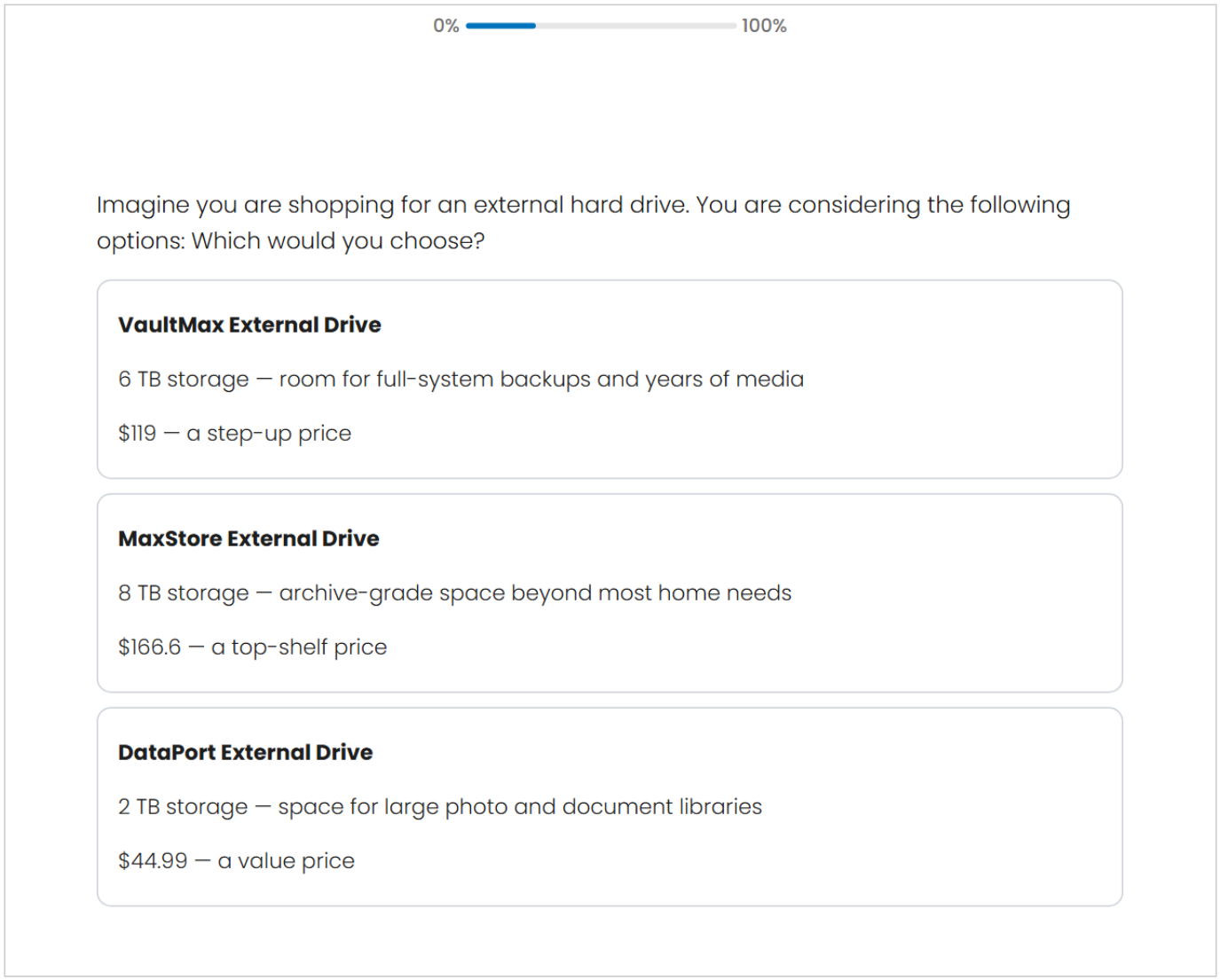
The instructions page (Surveys 1 and 2 say seven pages; Surveys 3 and 4 say three).



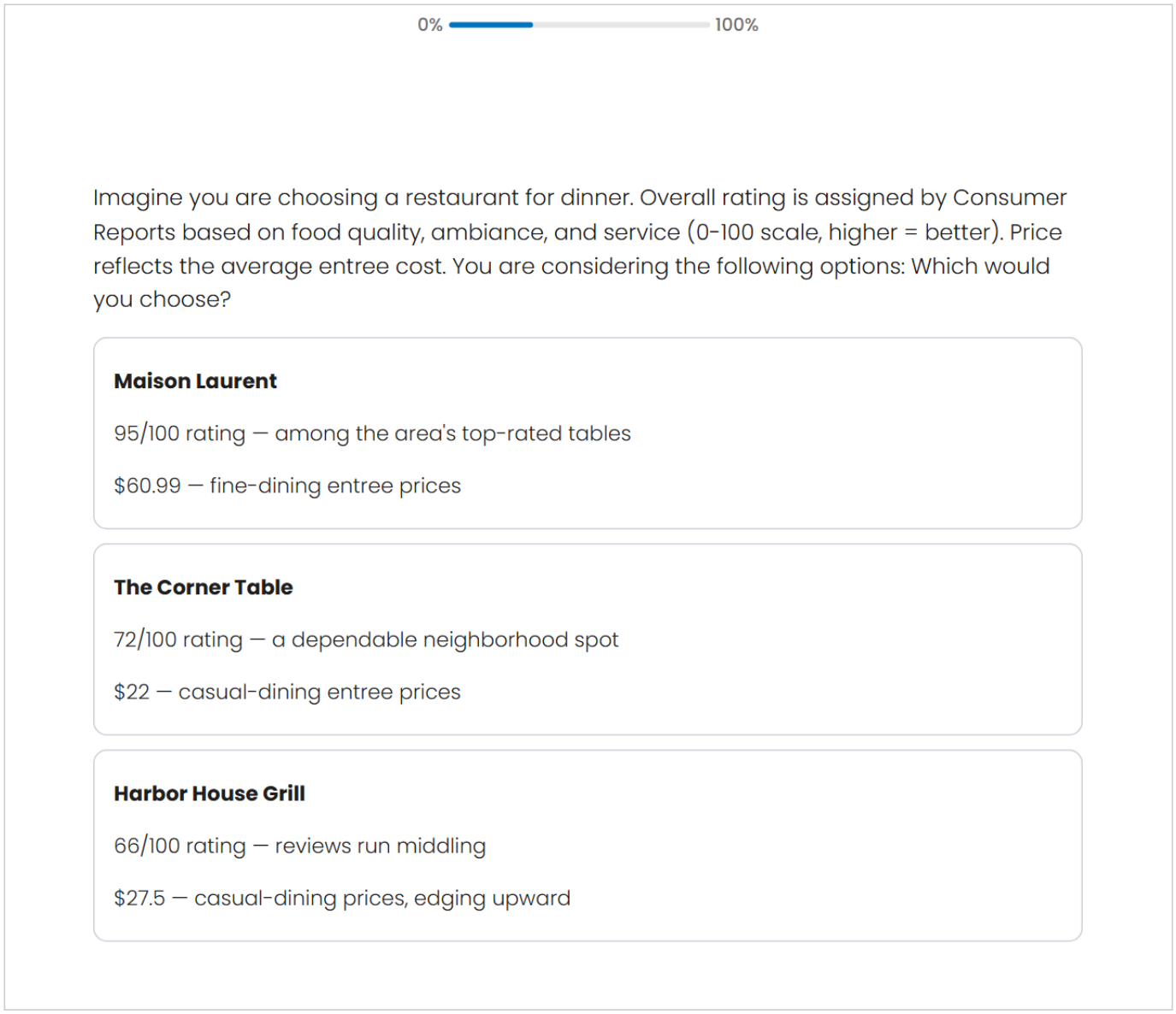
The attention check. Participants who do not select Strongly agree are excluded from every analysis; the survey does not stop them.



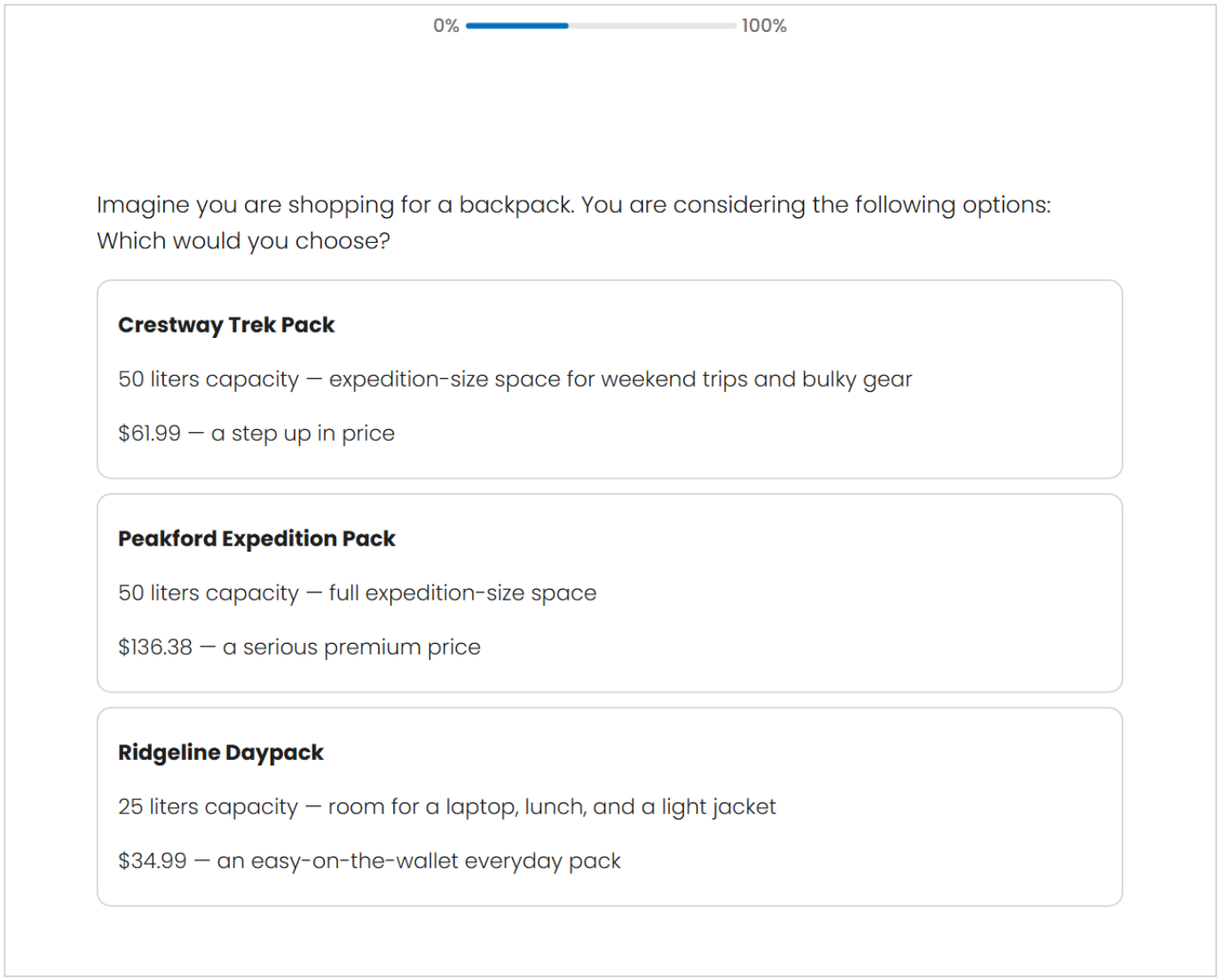
The two-option page, the baseline each effect is measured against. Category: Bluetooth speakers; new-values tier.



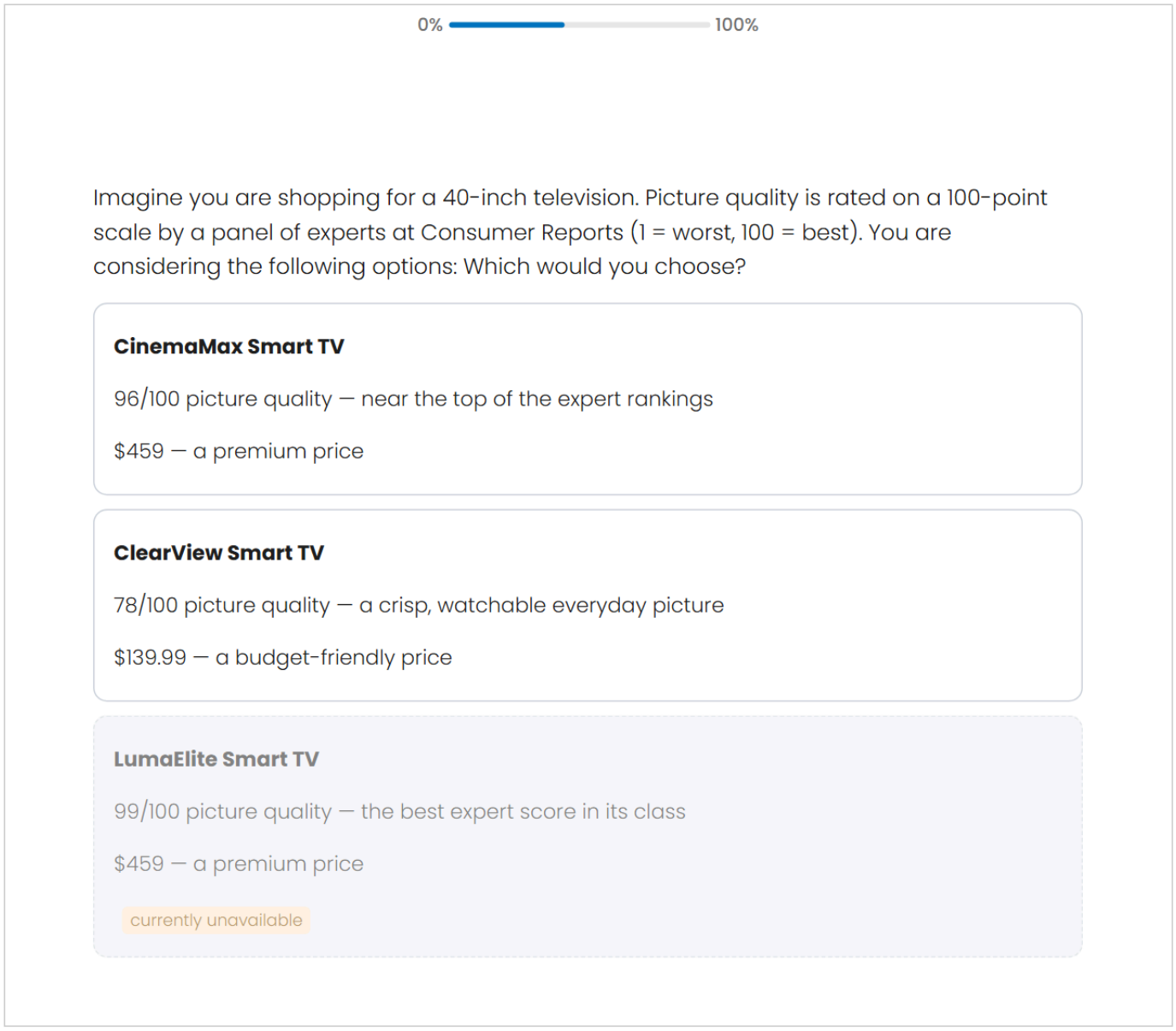
The compromise page: the two baseline options plus a more extreme third option, so one original becomes the middle choice. Category: external hard drives; new-values tier.



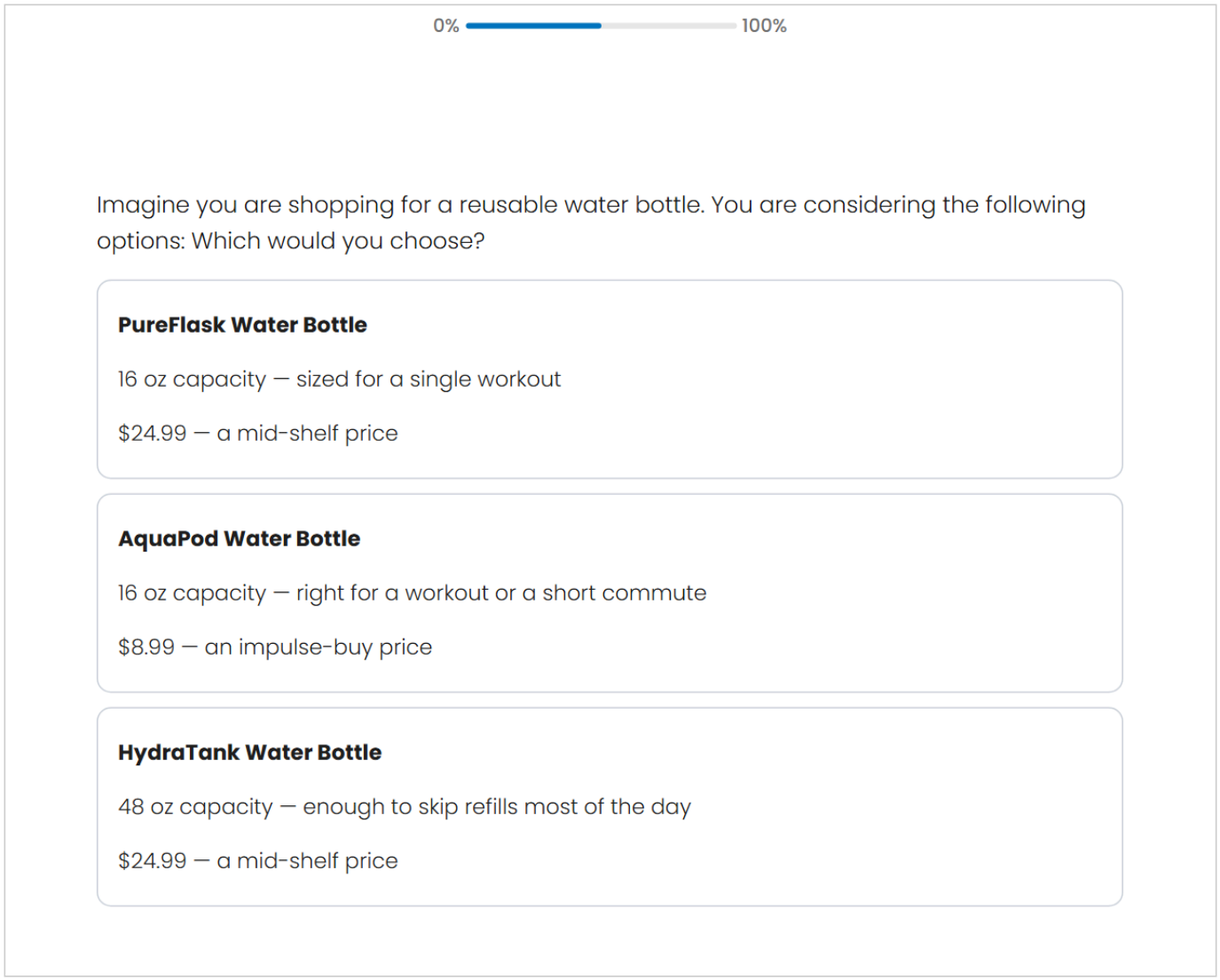
An attraction page with a frequency decoy: a third option modestly worse than the target on both attributes. Category: restaurants; new-values tier.



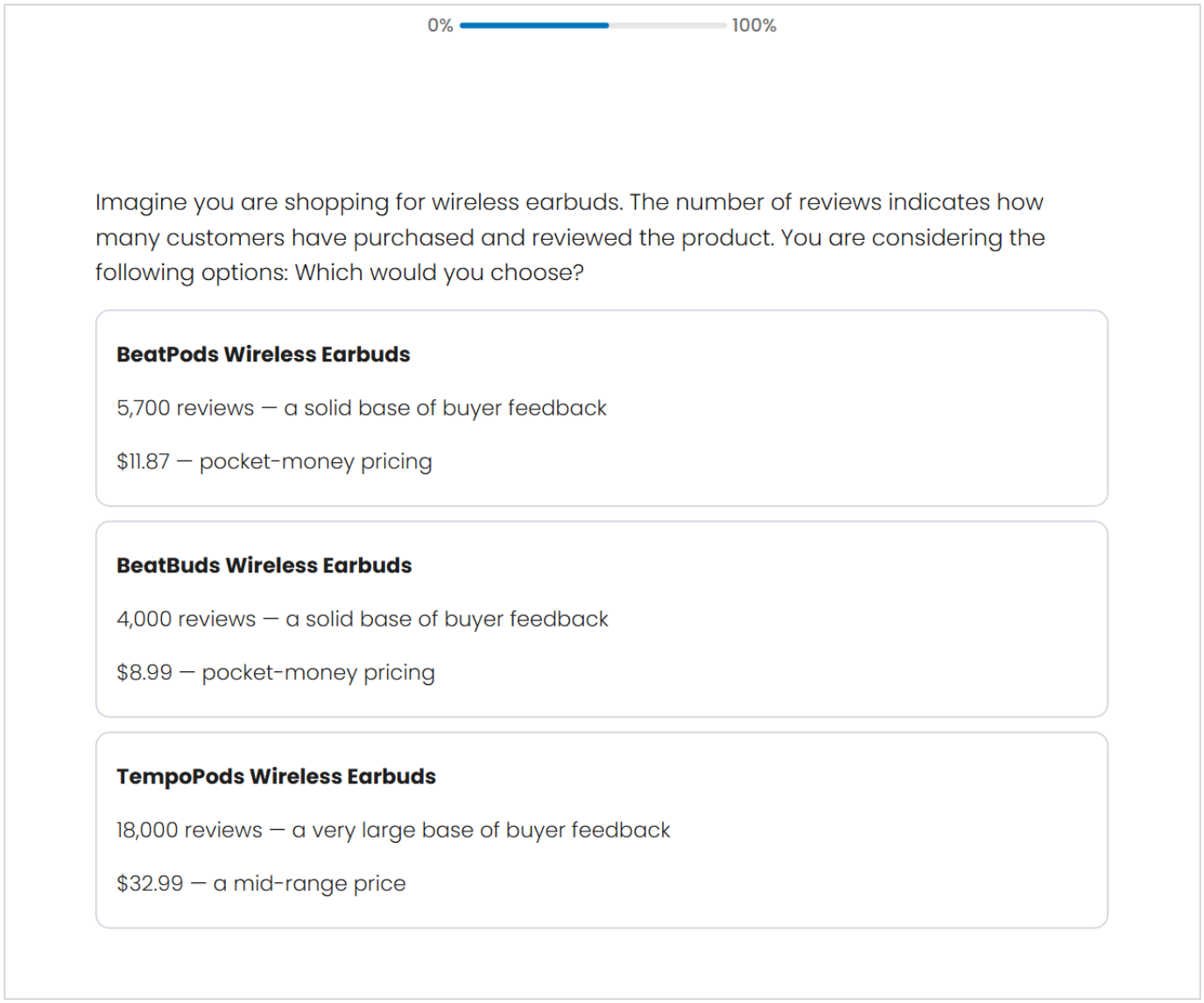
An attraction page with a range decoy: a third option far worse than the target on the attribute on which the target is weak. Category: backpacks; new-values tier.



The phantom page: a third option better than the target on one attribute but marked currently unavailable, so it cannot be chosen. Category: televisions; new-values tier.



The upscaling page: a third option worse than each original on a different attribute. Category: water bottles; new-values tier.



The similarity page: a third option that is a near copy of one of the two originals. Category: wireless earbuds; new-values tier. Here the near copy is of the budget option (lower price).

0% 100%

Imagine you are shopping for an external hard drive. You are considering the following options: Which would you choose?

4 TB storage

$82

6 TB storage

$119

2 TB storage

$44.99

4 TB storage

$82

2 TB storage

$44.99

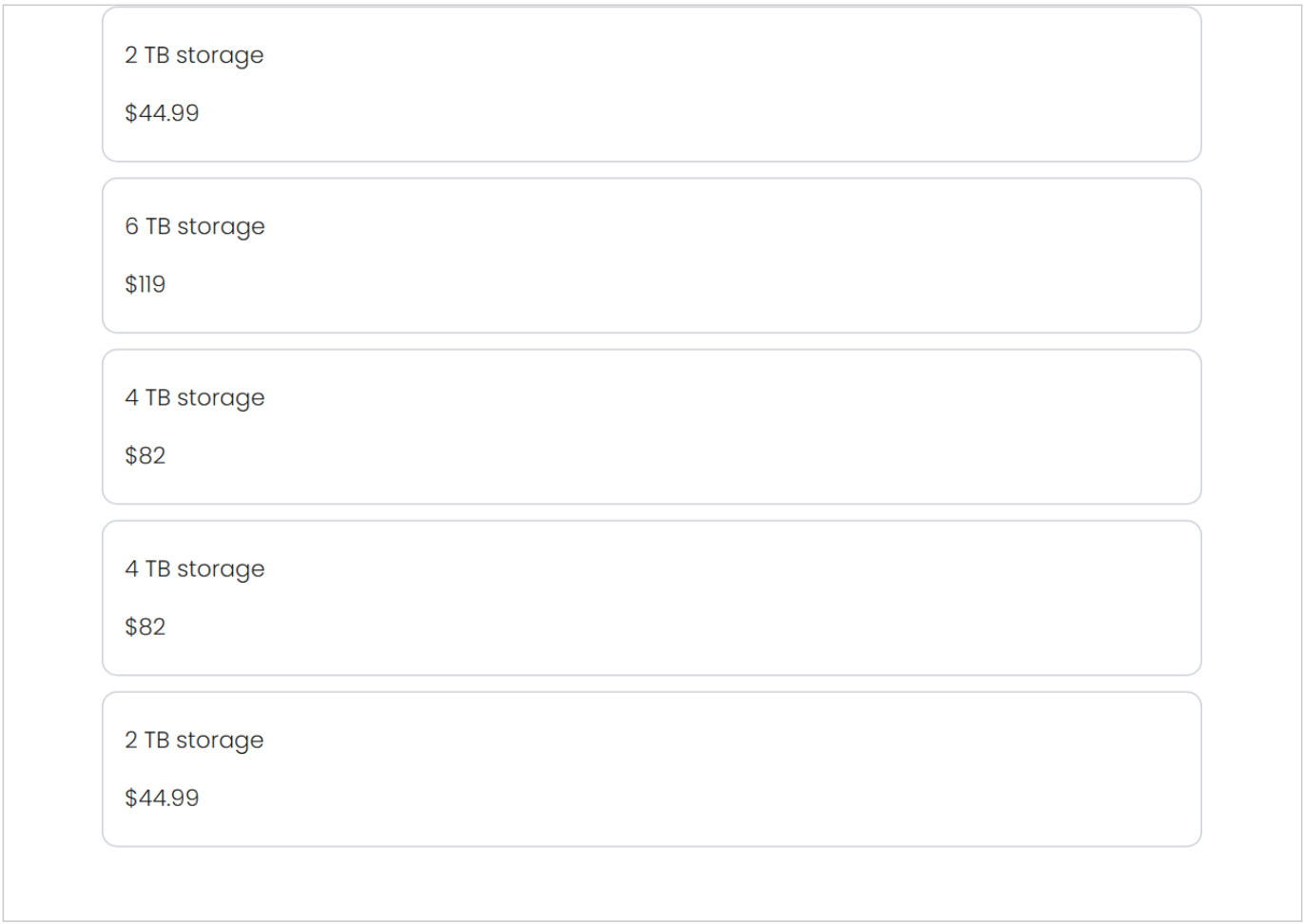
6 TB storage

$119

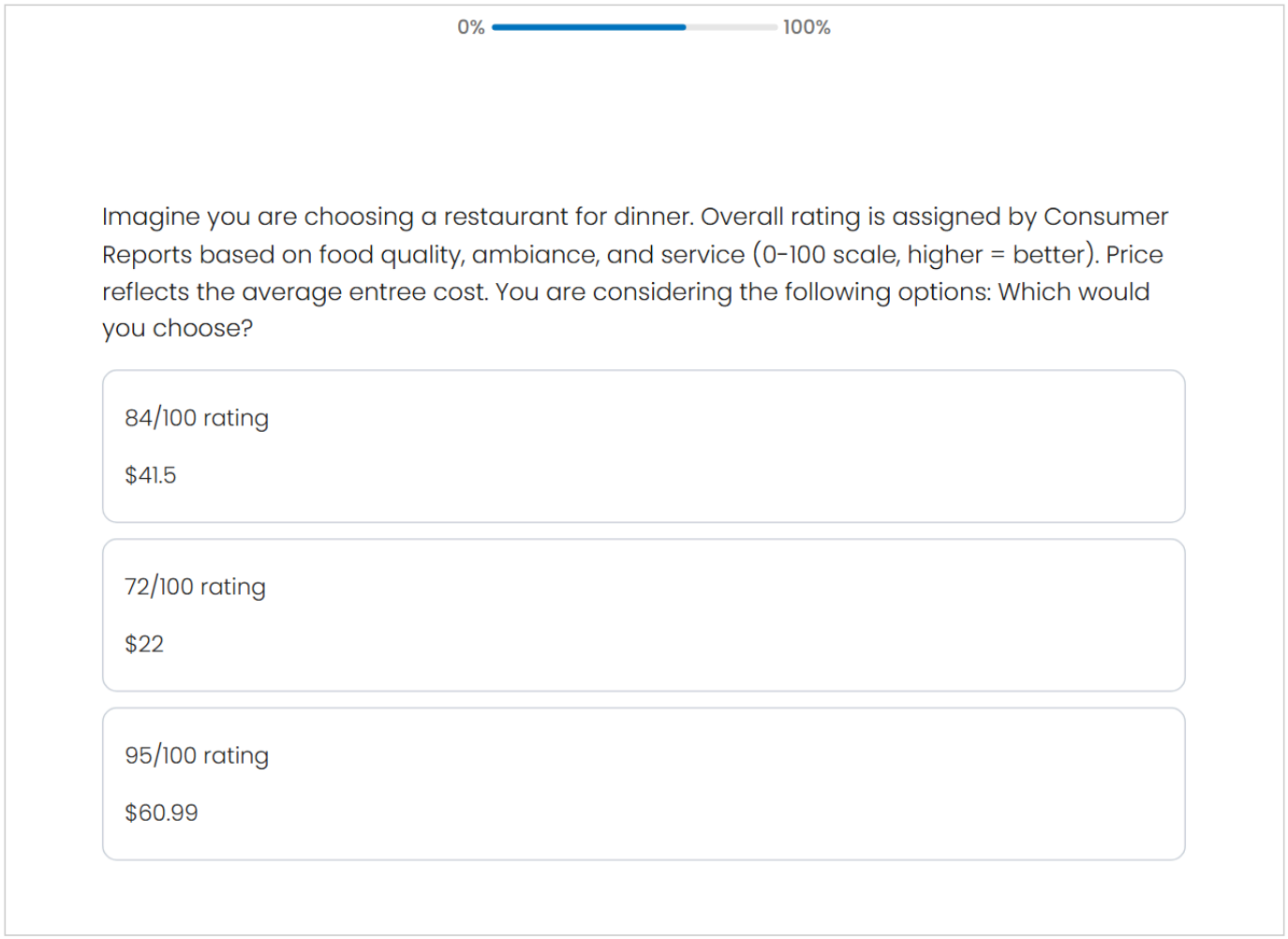
6 TB storage

$119

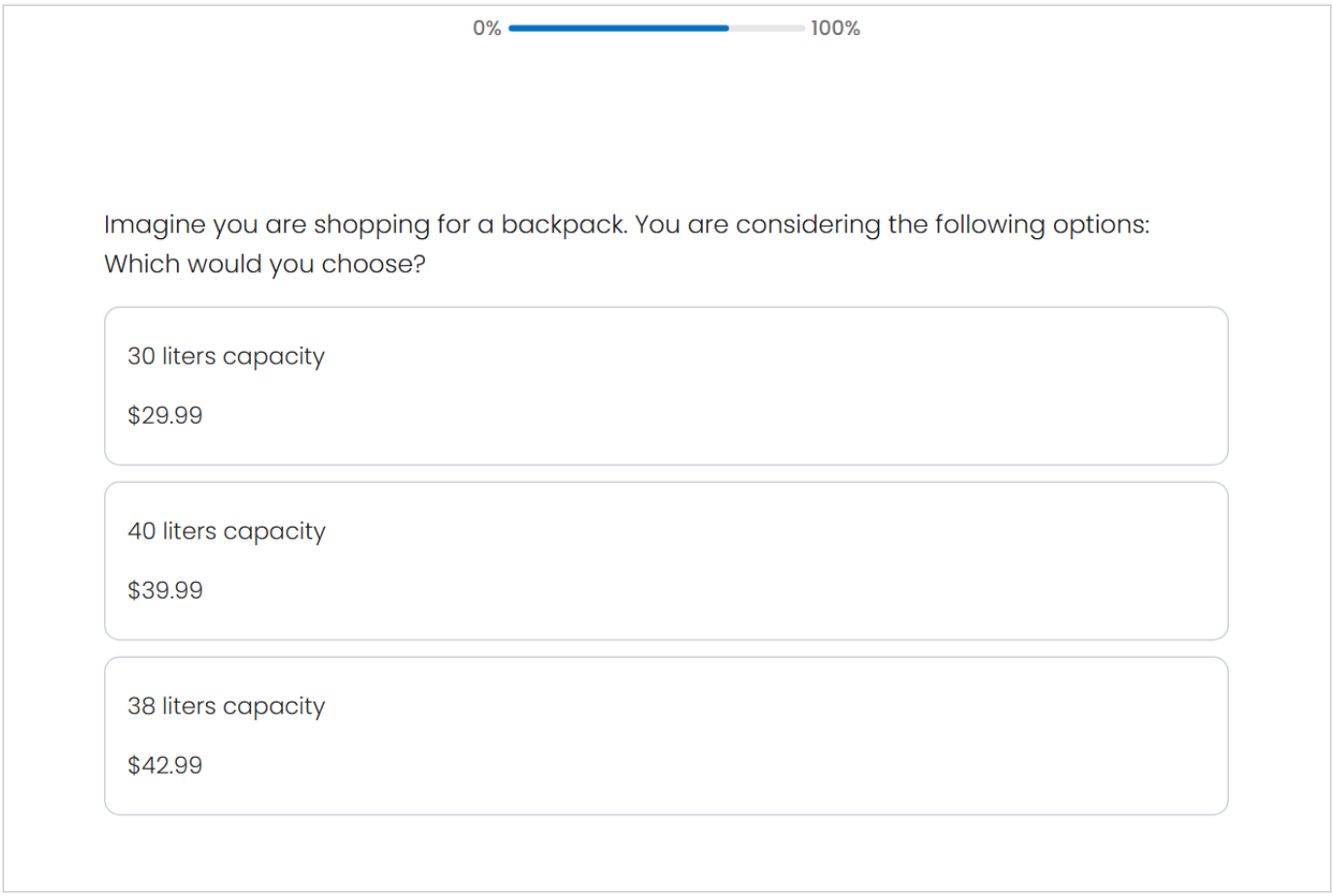
(this page continues on the next PDF page, part 1 of 2)



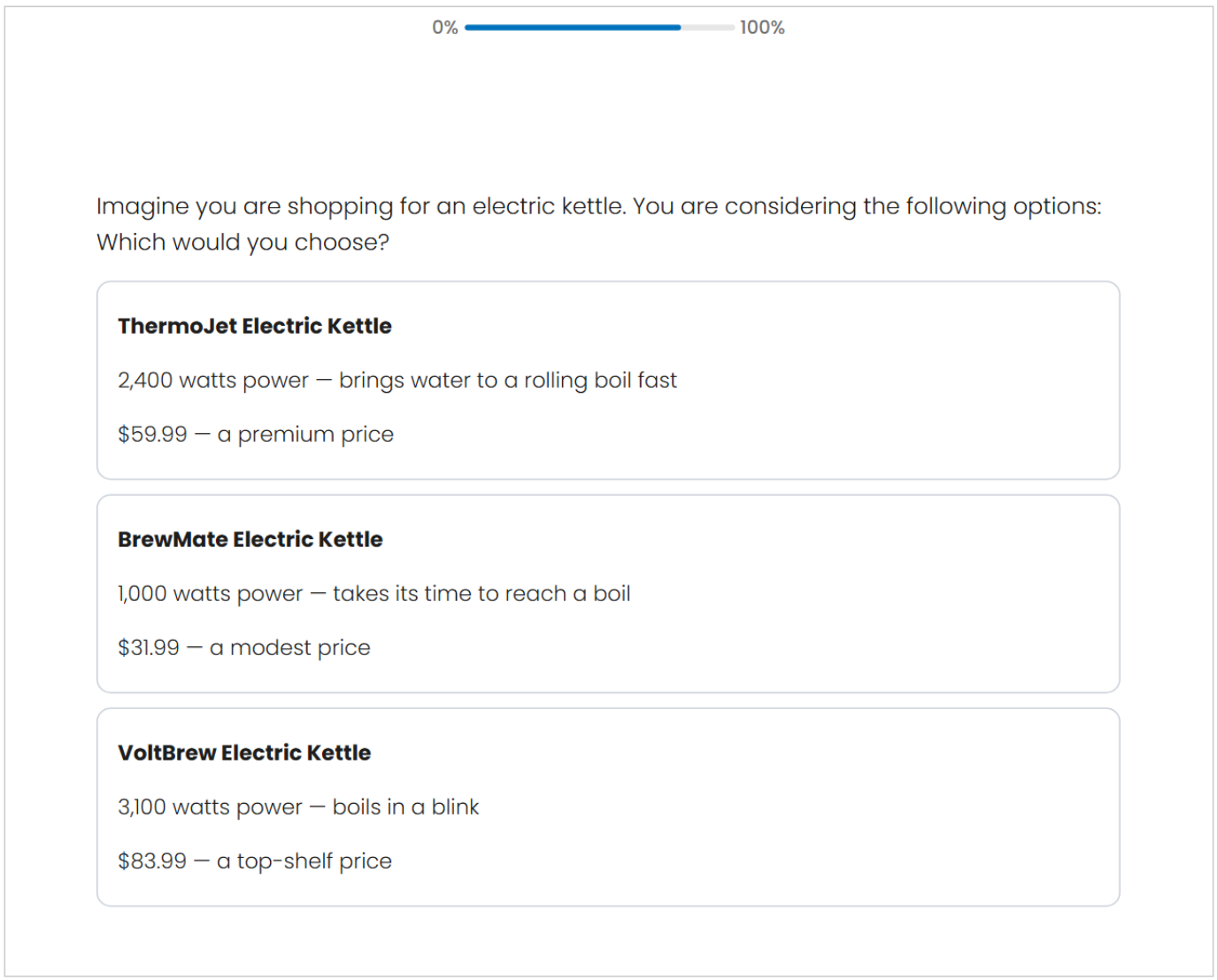
The extremity menu: twelve options, four at each of three quality levels (the page scrolls). Category: external hard drives; new-values tier.



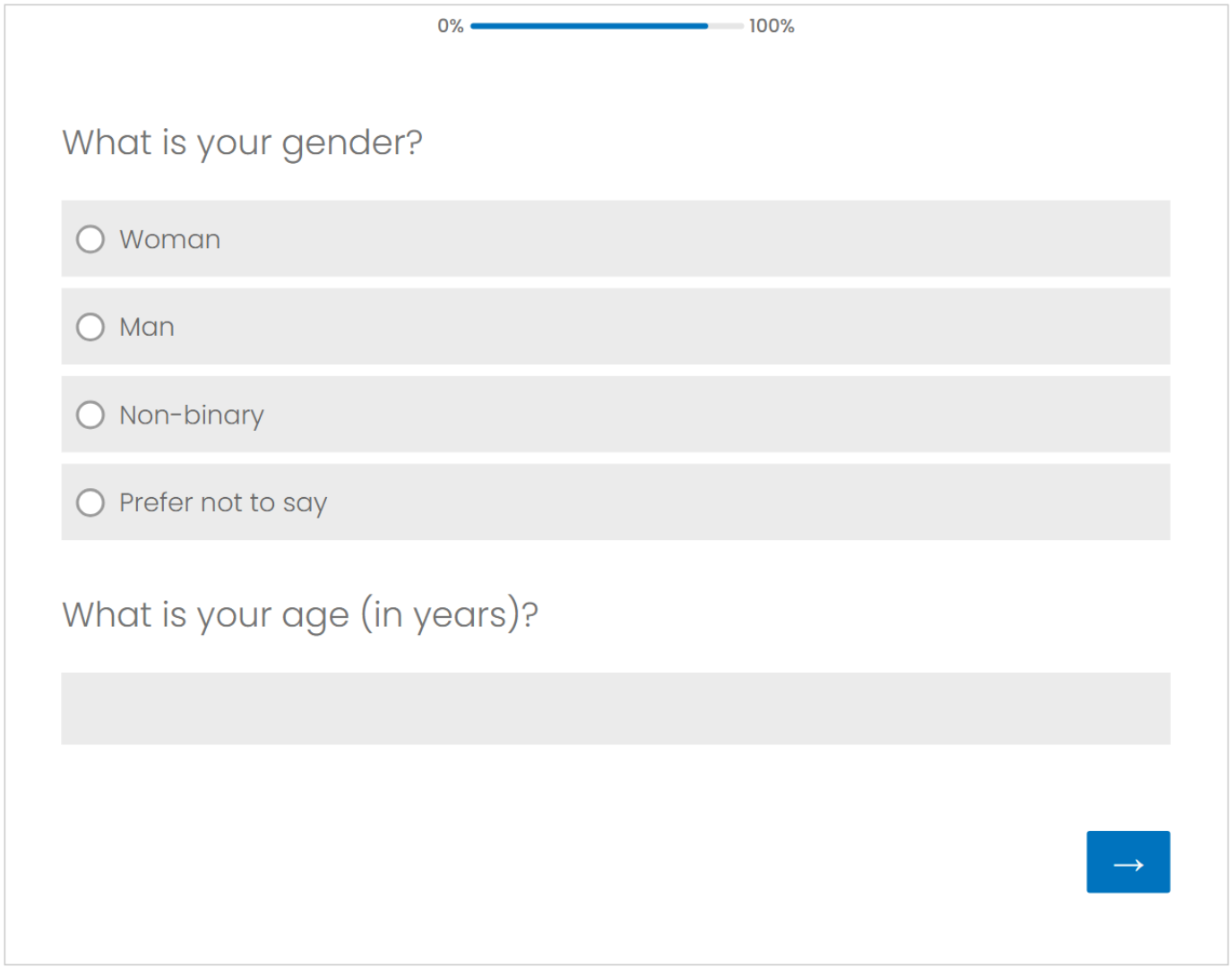
The matched extremity control: one option at each of the same three quality levels. Category: restaurants; new-values tier.



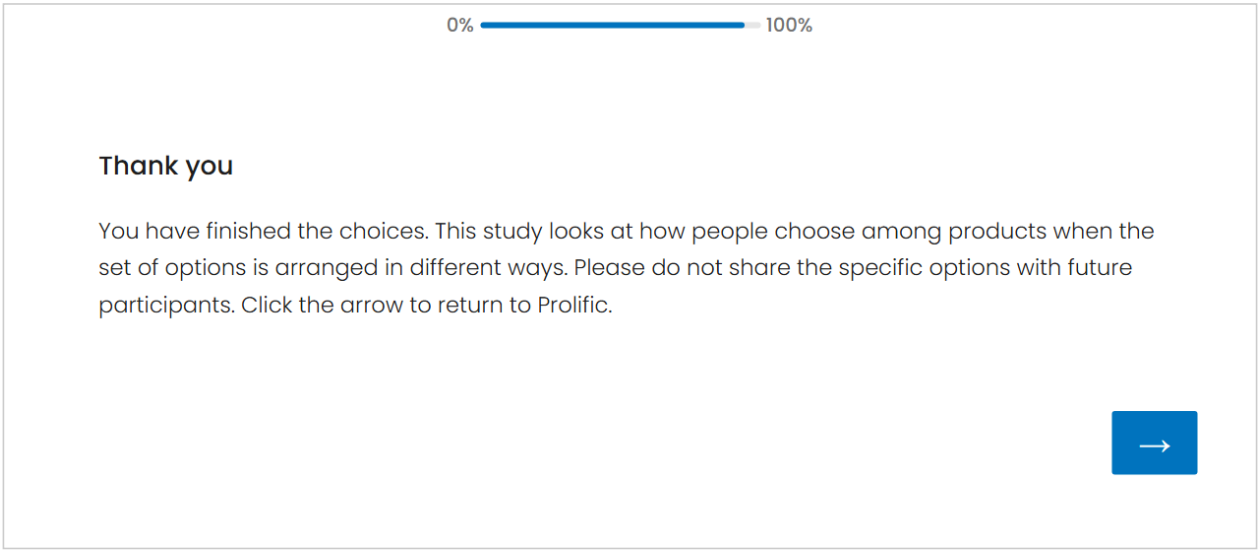
An attraction page with a frequency decoy: a third option modestly worse than the target on both attributes. Category: backpacks; published-values tier. Published-values pages keep the plain wording of the original studies.



The compromise page: the two baseline options plus a more extreme third option, so one original becomes the middle choice. Category: electric kettles; invented-category tier. The last three categories are invented, so no model can have seen them in published work.



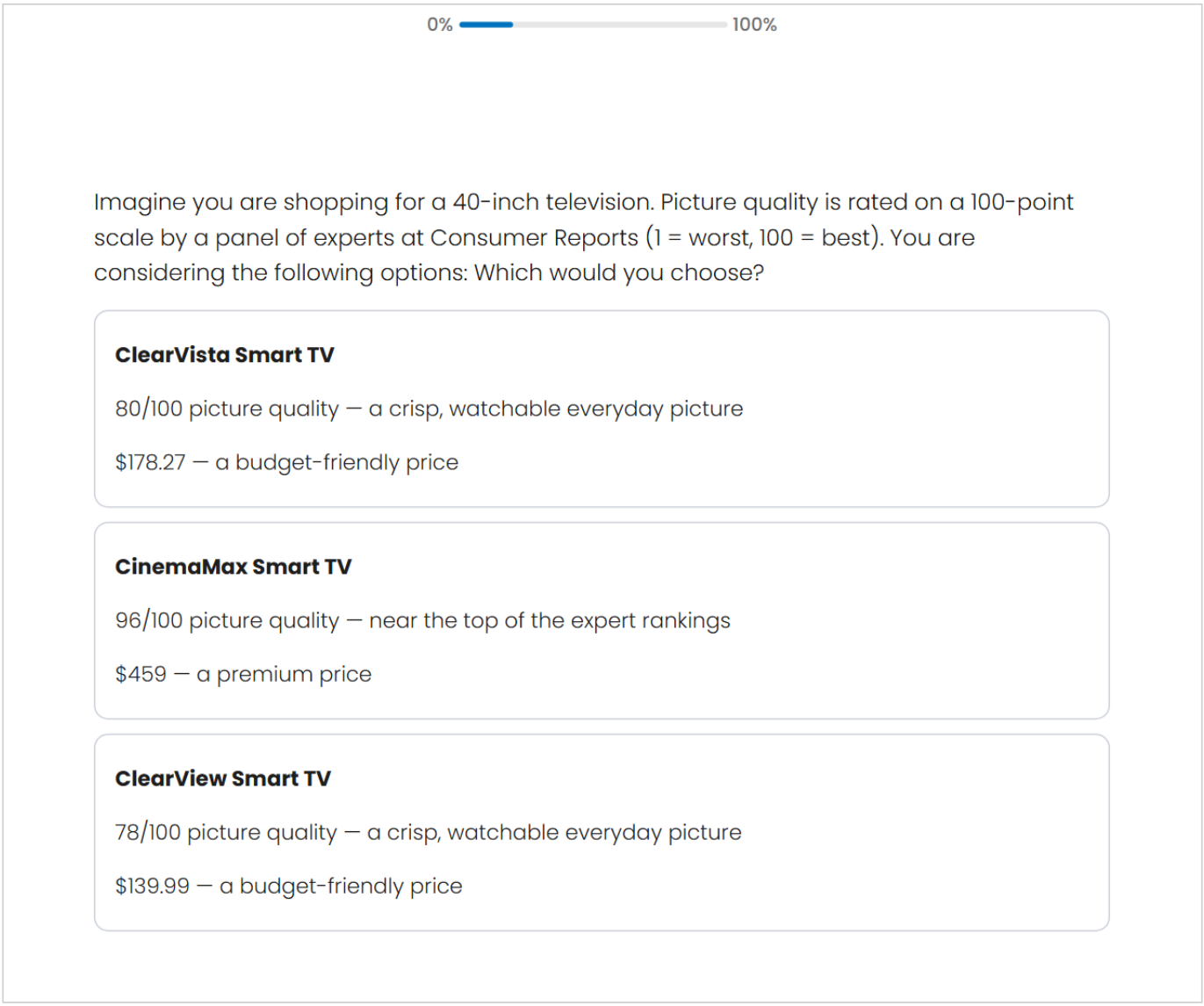
The two demographic questions, both required; age must be a number.



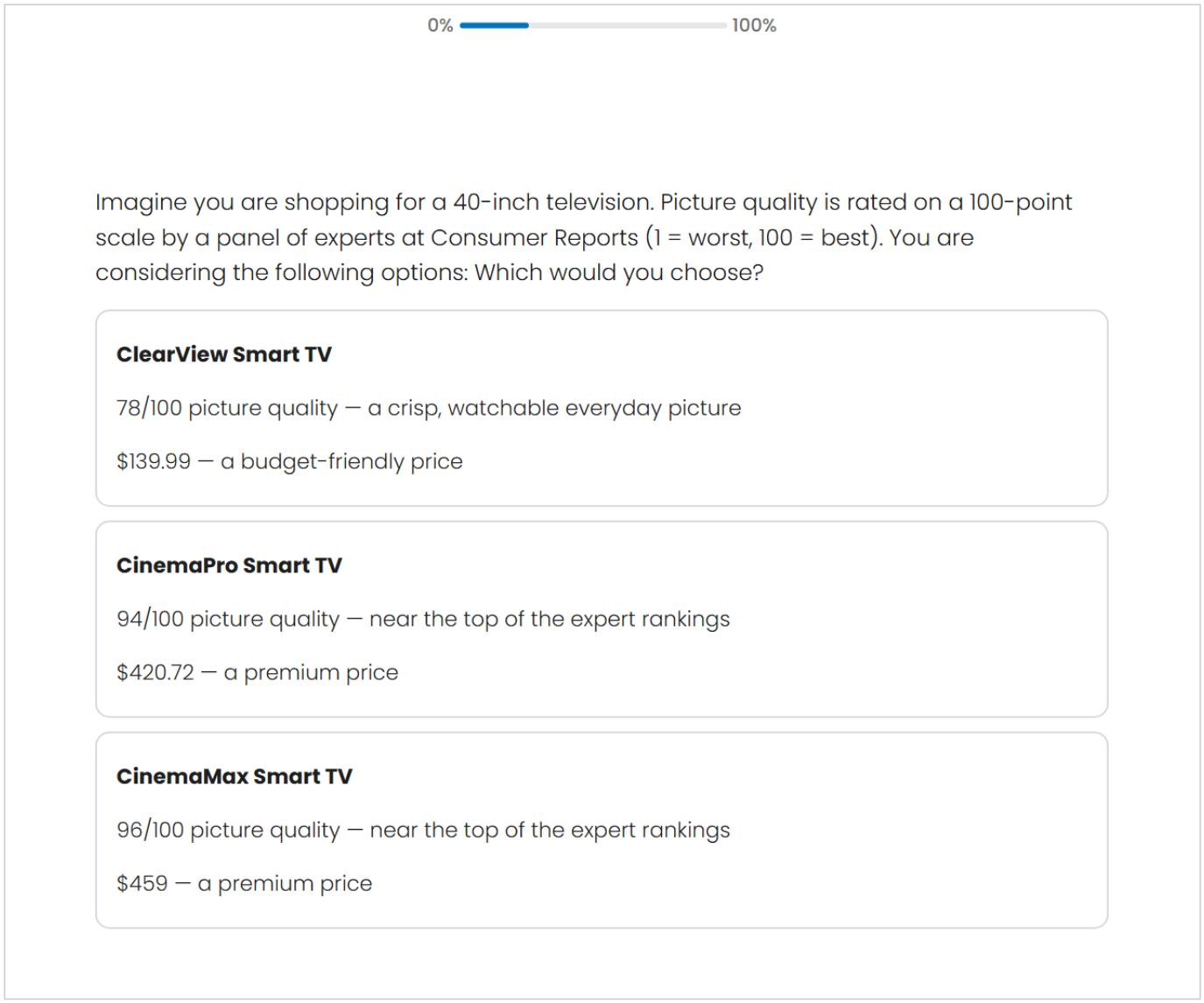
The last page. The arrow returns the participant to Prolific with the study's completion code, which is a placeholder (REPLACE_COMPLETION_CODE) until launch.

Survey 2: similarity survey

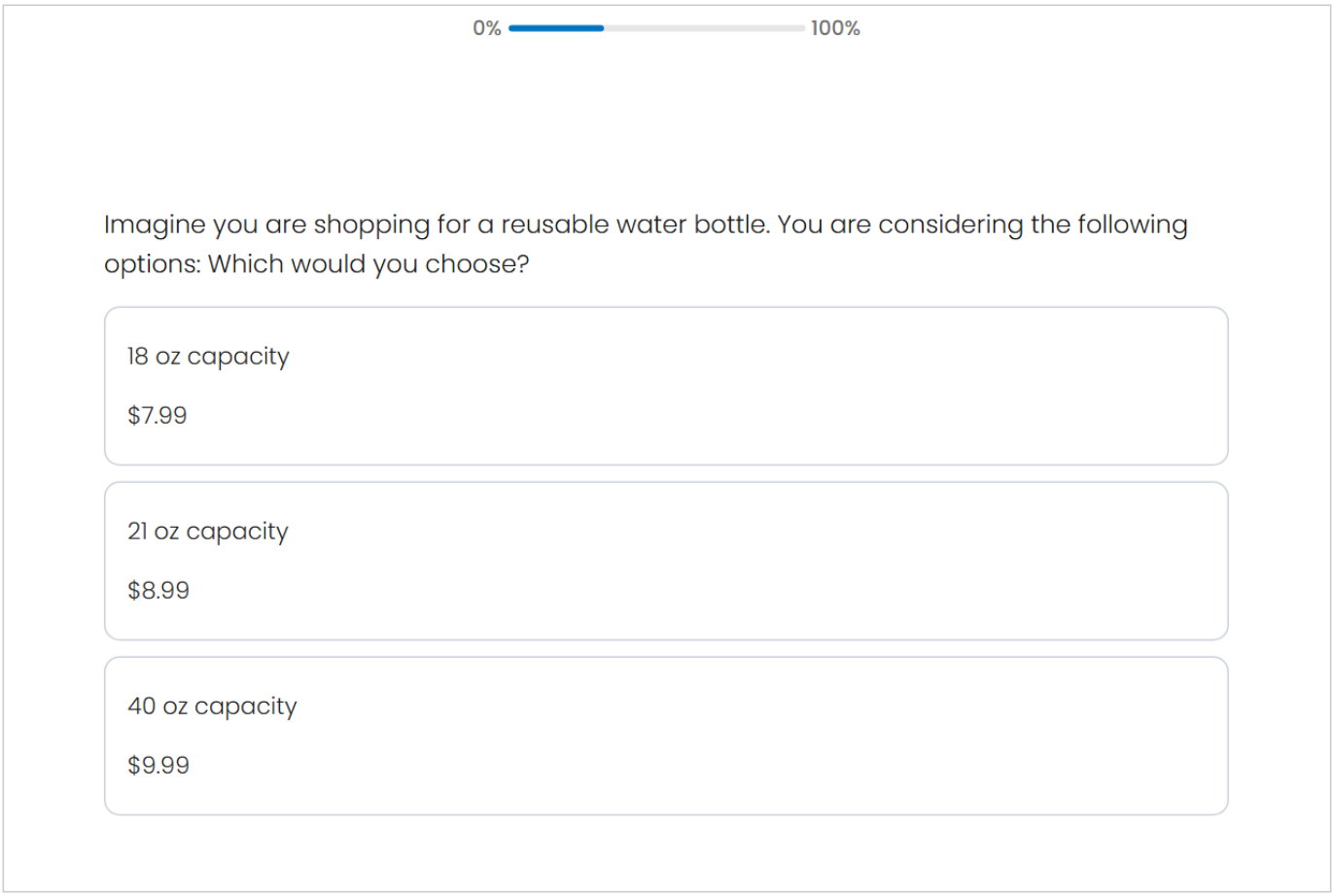
About 1,000 participants make seven similarity choices each, shown with numbers, so that each similarity condition reaches its registered size with the copy in either position. Its consent, instructions, attention check, demographic and last pages are identical to Survey 1's; only its choice pages are shown.



The similarity page: a third option that is a near copy of one of the two originals. Category: televisions; new-values tier. Here the near copy is of the budget option (lower price).



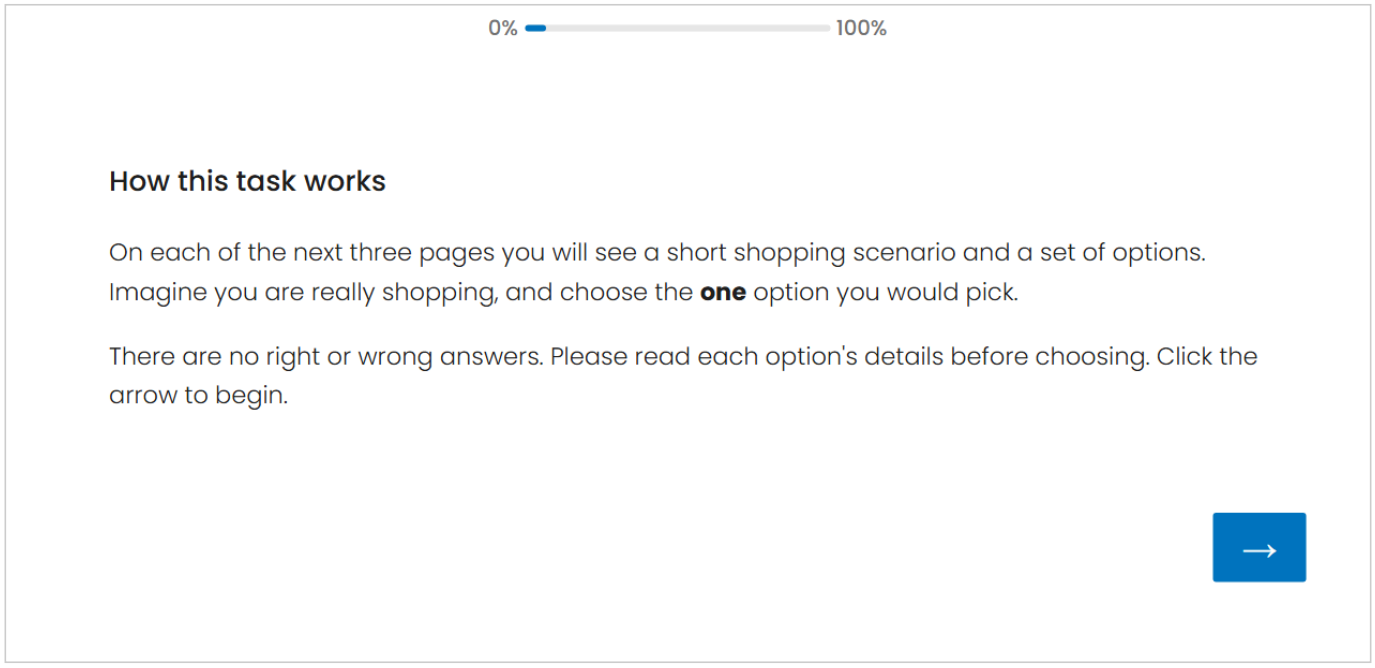
The similarity page: a third option that is a near copy of one of the two originals. Category: televisions; new-values tier. Here the near copy is of the premium option (higher quality, higher price). Same category as the page above, with the copy on the other side.



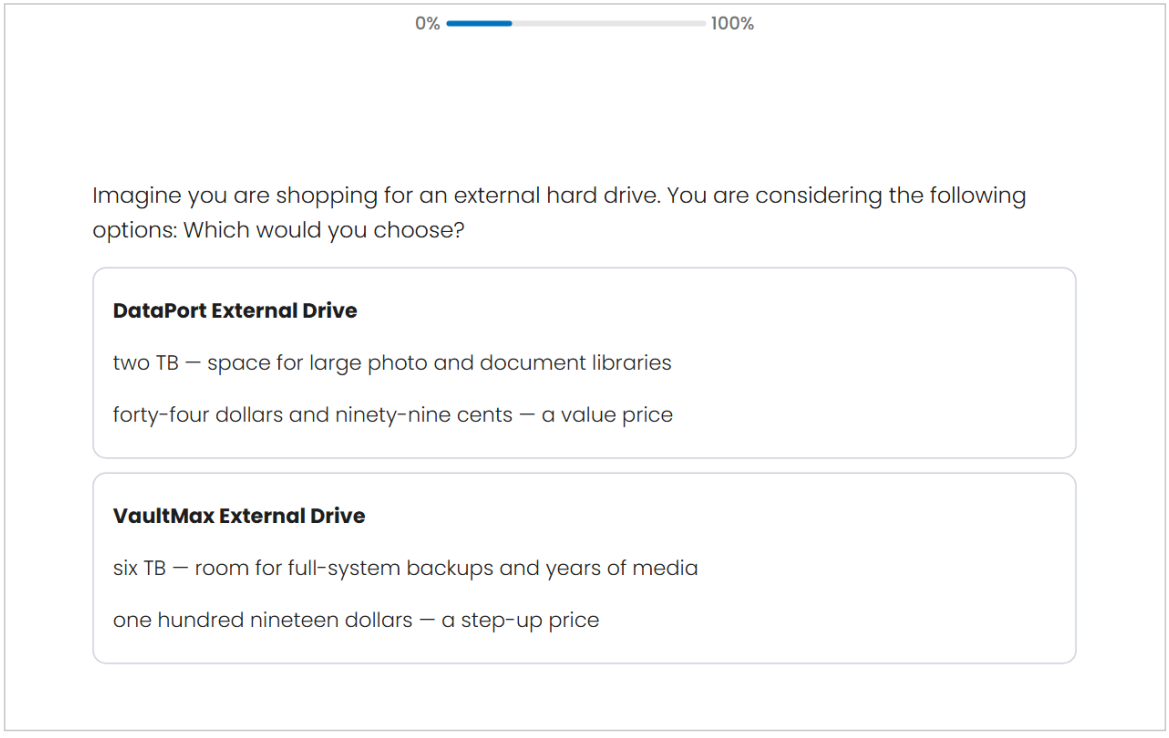
The similarity page: a third option that is a near copy of one of the two originals. Category: water bottles; published-values tier. Here the near copy is of the budget option (lower price).

Survey 3, words version

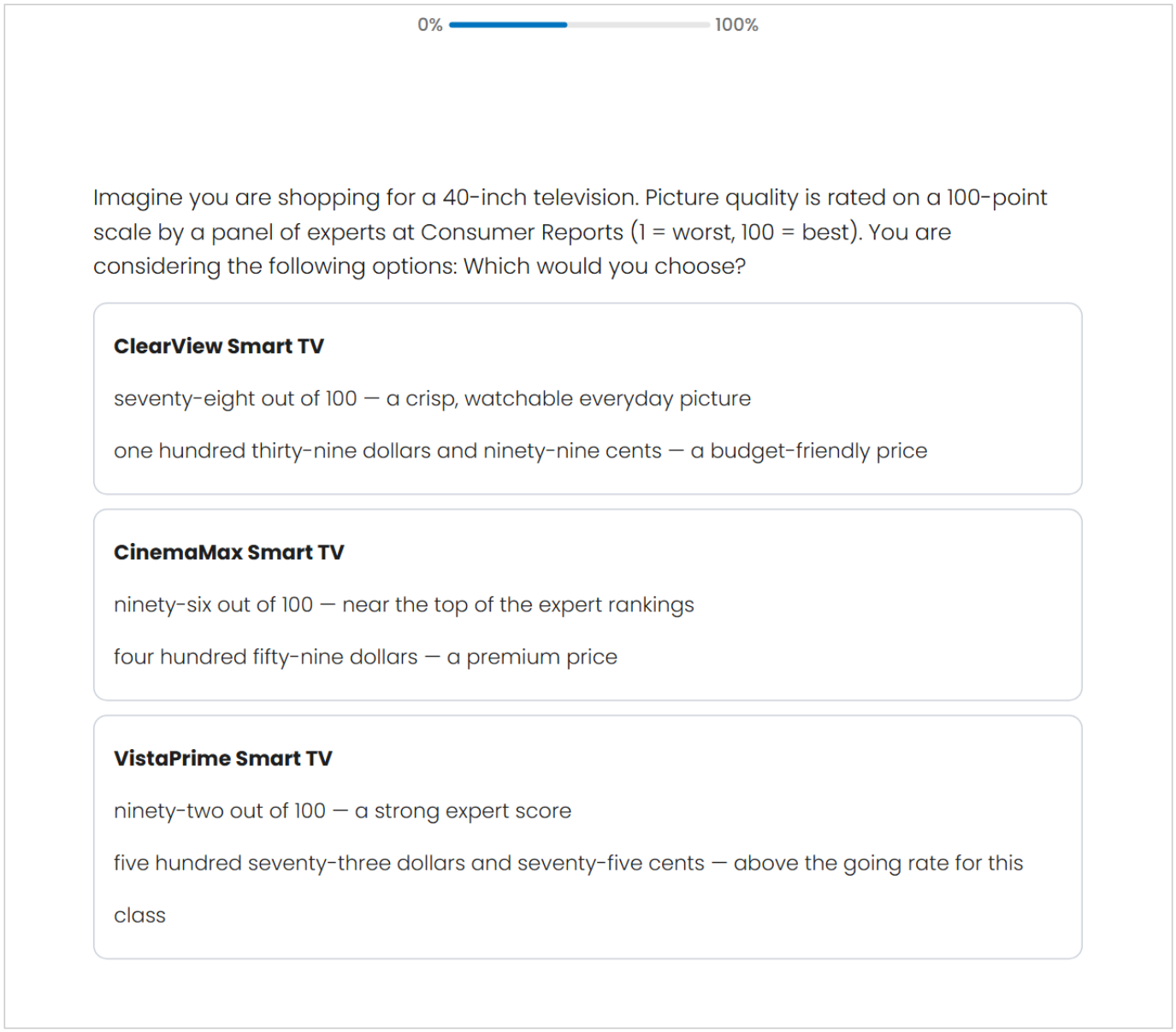
About 2,800 participants make three choices each with every attribute value and price spelled out in words, across four categories. The consent, attention check, demographic and last pages are identical to Survey 1's; the instructions page and one choice page of each type are shown.



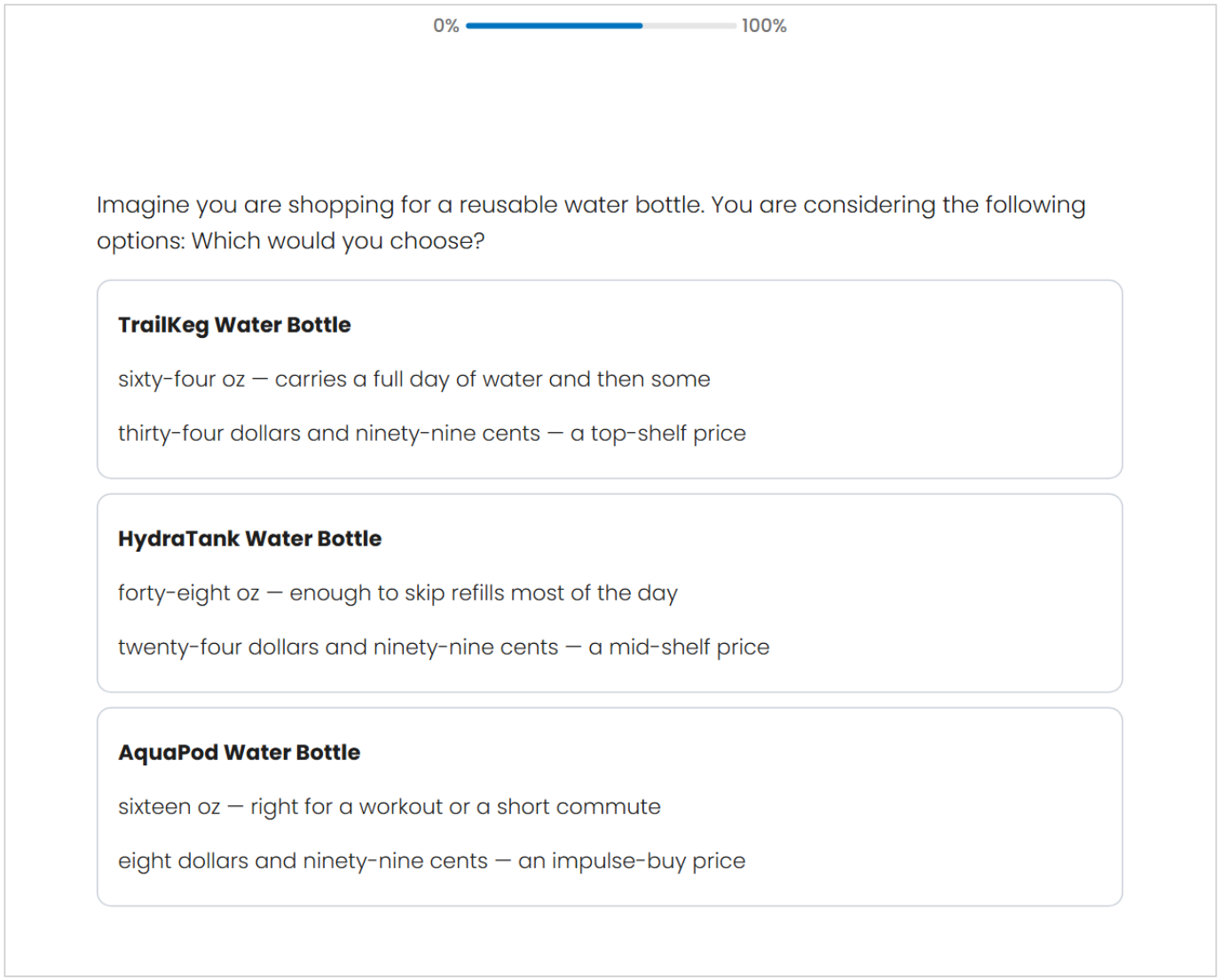
The instructions page of the three-choice surveys (Surveys 3 and 4).



The two-option page, the baseline each effect is measured against. Category: external hard drives; new-values tier. Every attribute value and price is spelled out in words.



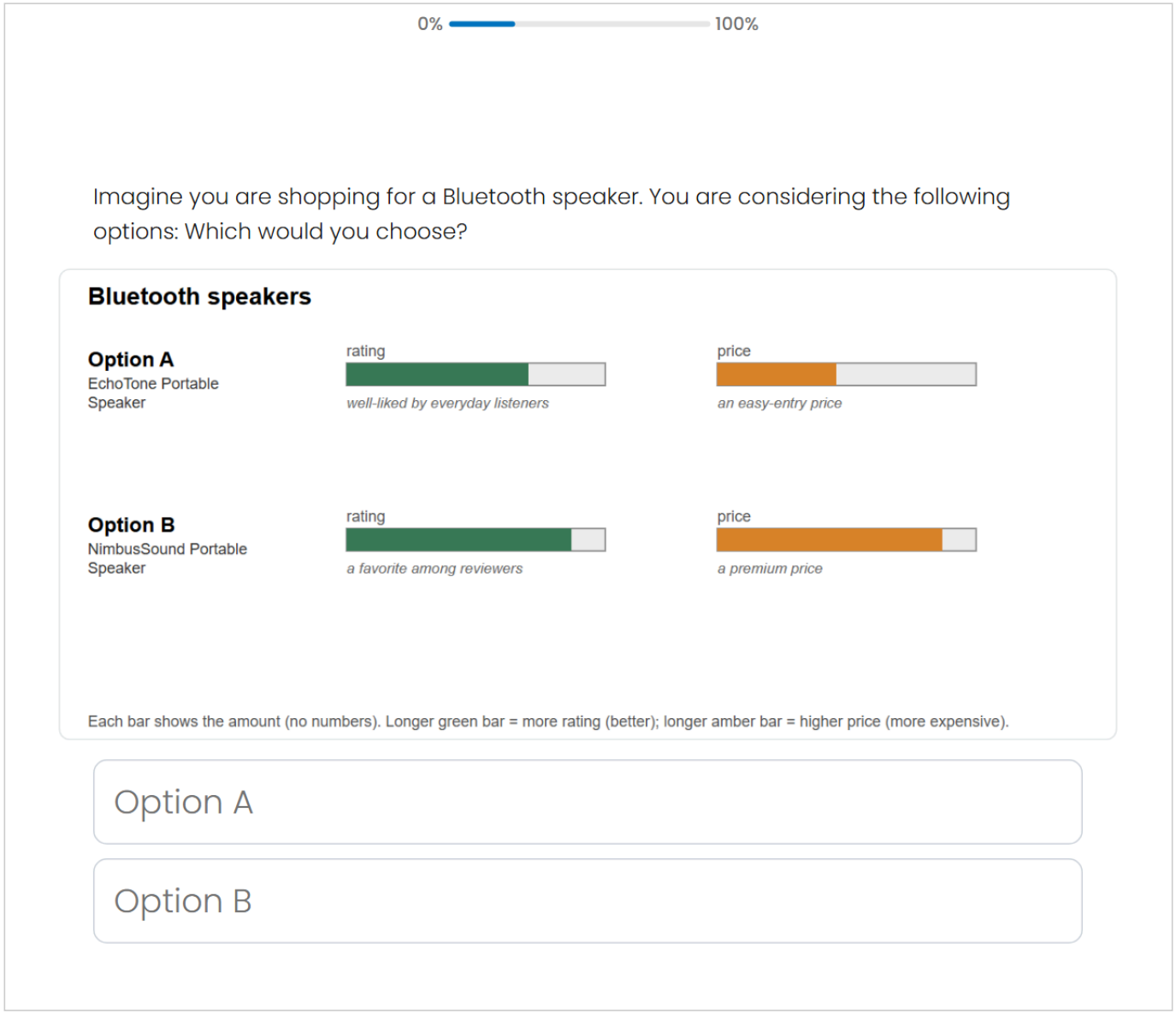
An attraction page with a frequency decoy: a third option modestly worse than the target on both attributes. Category: televisions; new-values tier. Every attribute value and price is spelled out in words; a rating keeps its scale in digits (out of 100).



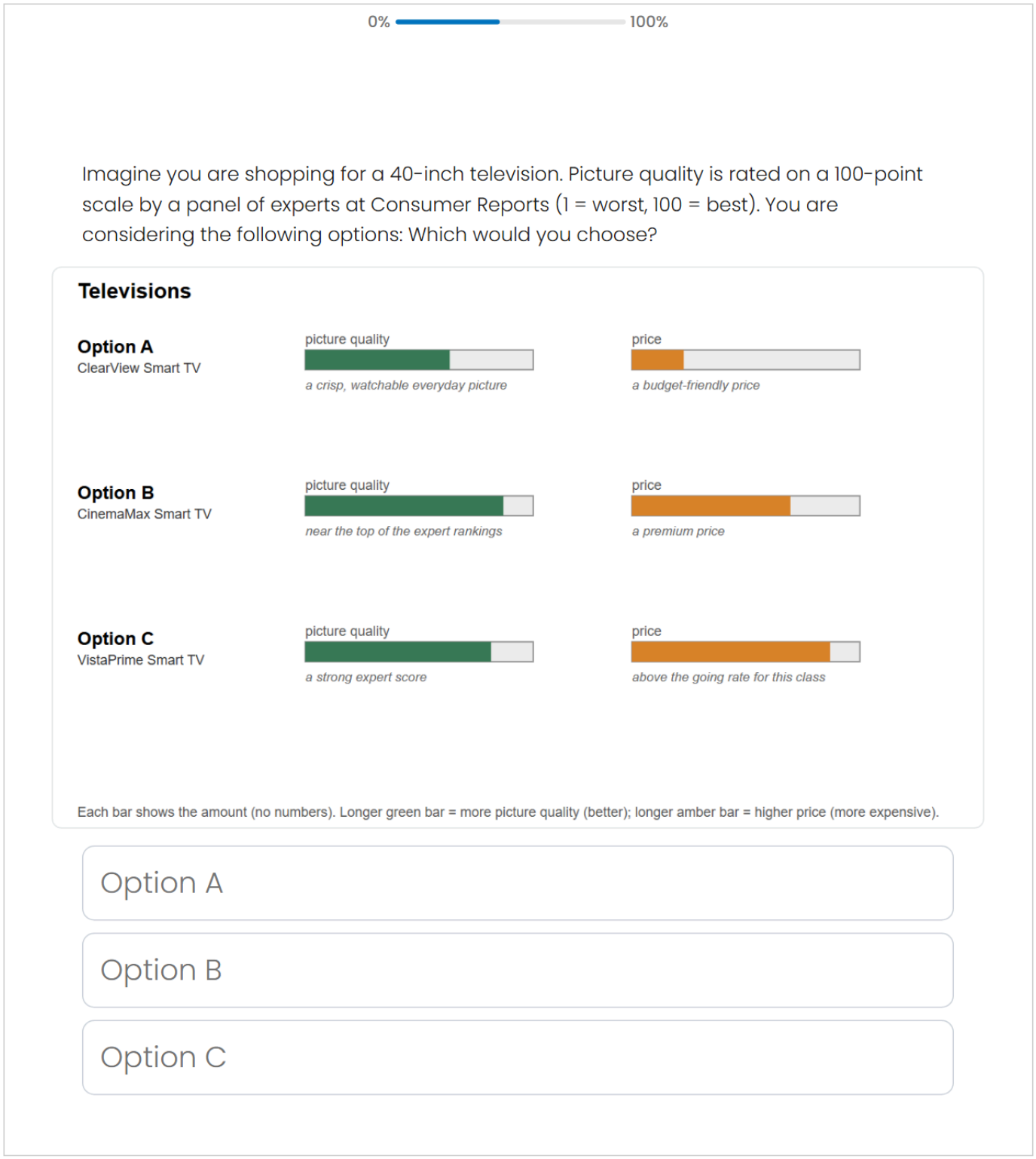
The compromise page: the two baseline options plus a more extreme third option, so one original becomes the middle choice. Category: water bottles; new-values tier. Every attribute value and price is spelled out in words.

Survey 3, pictures version

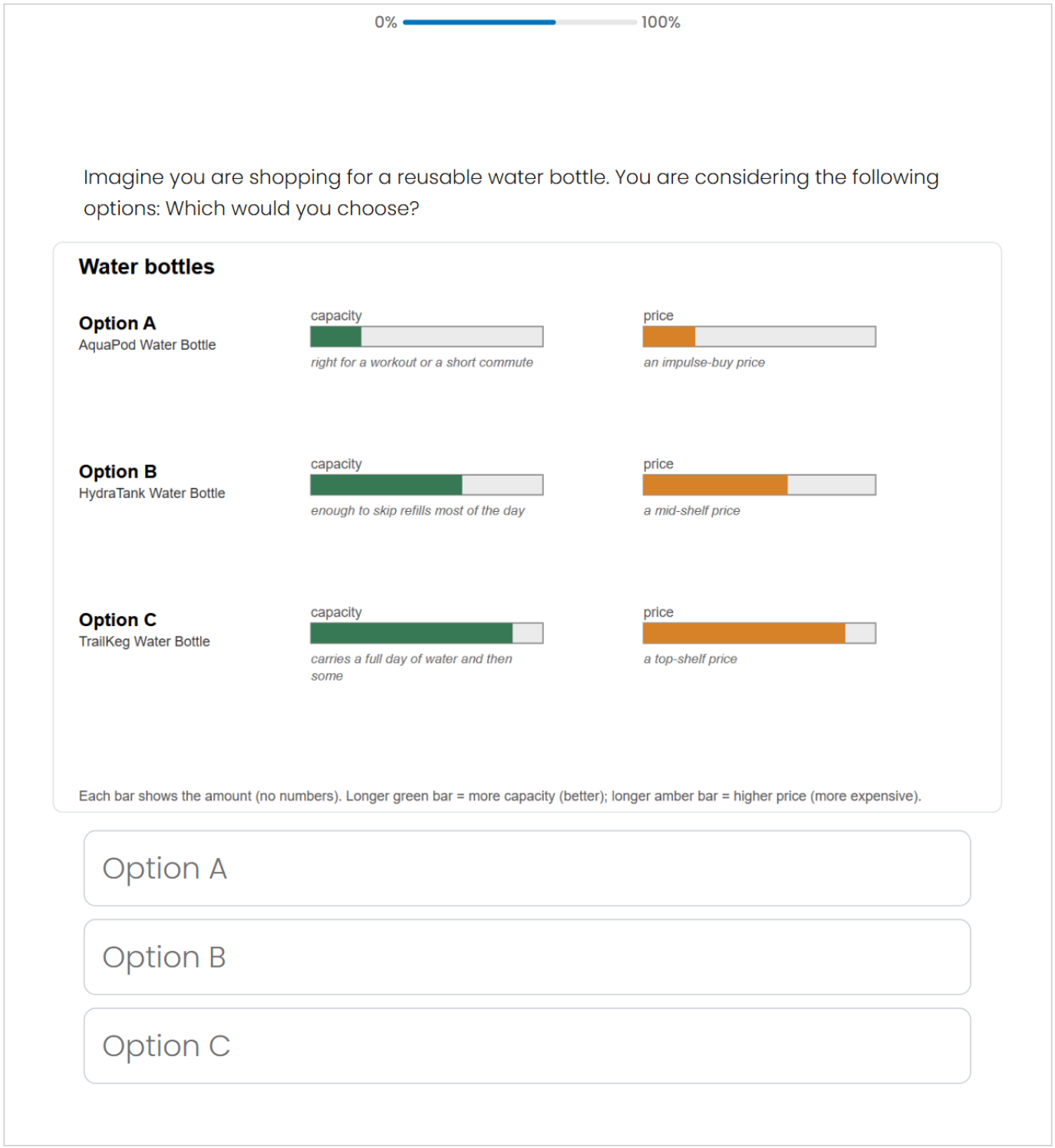
About 2,100 participants make three choices each, one in each of three categories, with the values drawn as bars and no numbers. The other pages are identical to the words version.



The two-option page, the baseline each effect is measured against. Category: Bluetooth speakers; new-values tier. The values appear only as bars in the picture; the participant chooses by the option's letter. The picture is the same file the models receive.



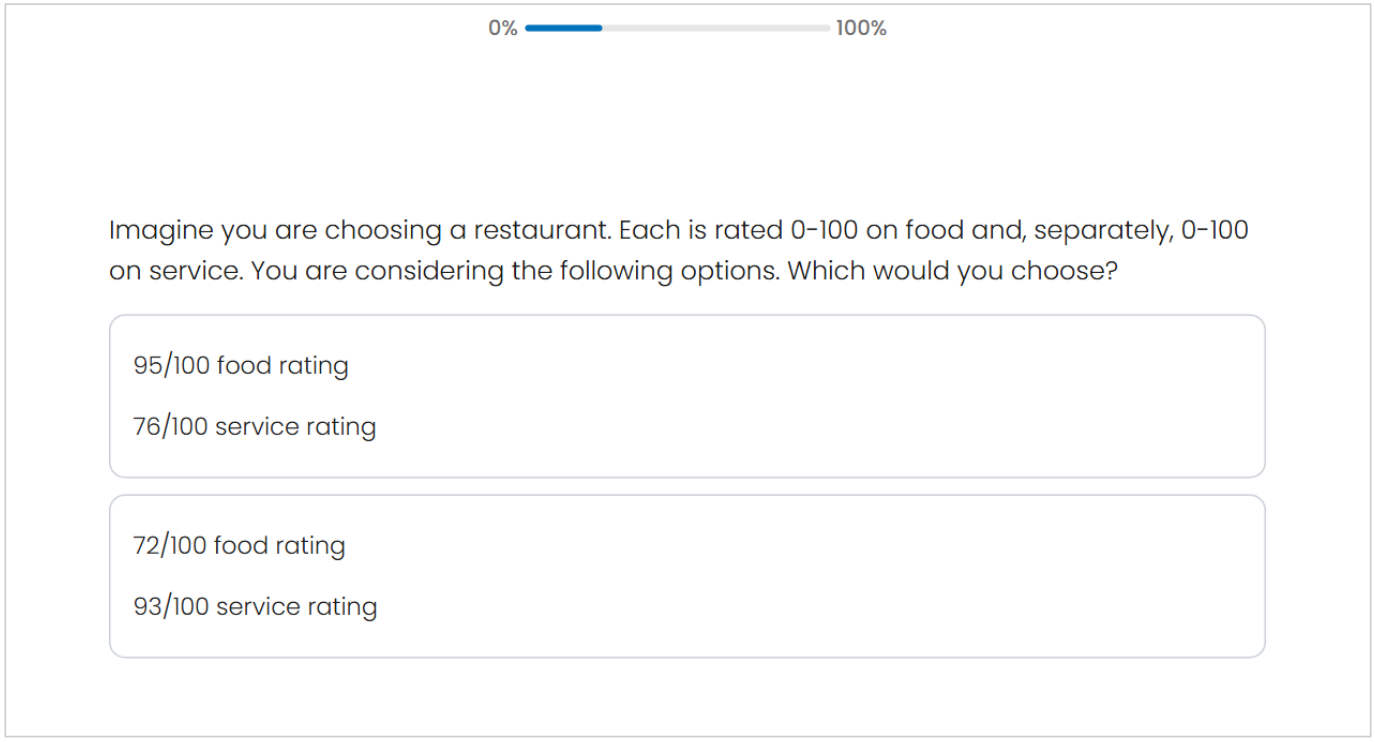
An attraction page with a frequency decoy: a third option modestly worse than the target on both attributes. Category: televisions; new-values tier. The values appear only as bars in the picture; the participant chooses by the option's letter. The picture is the same file the models receive.



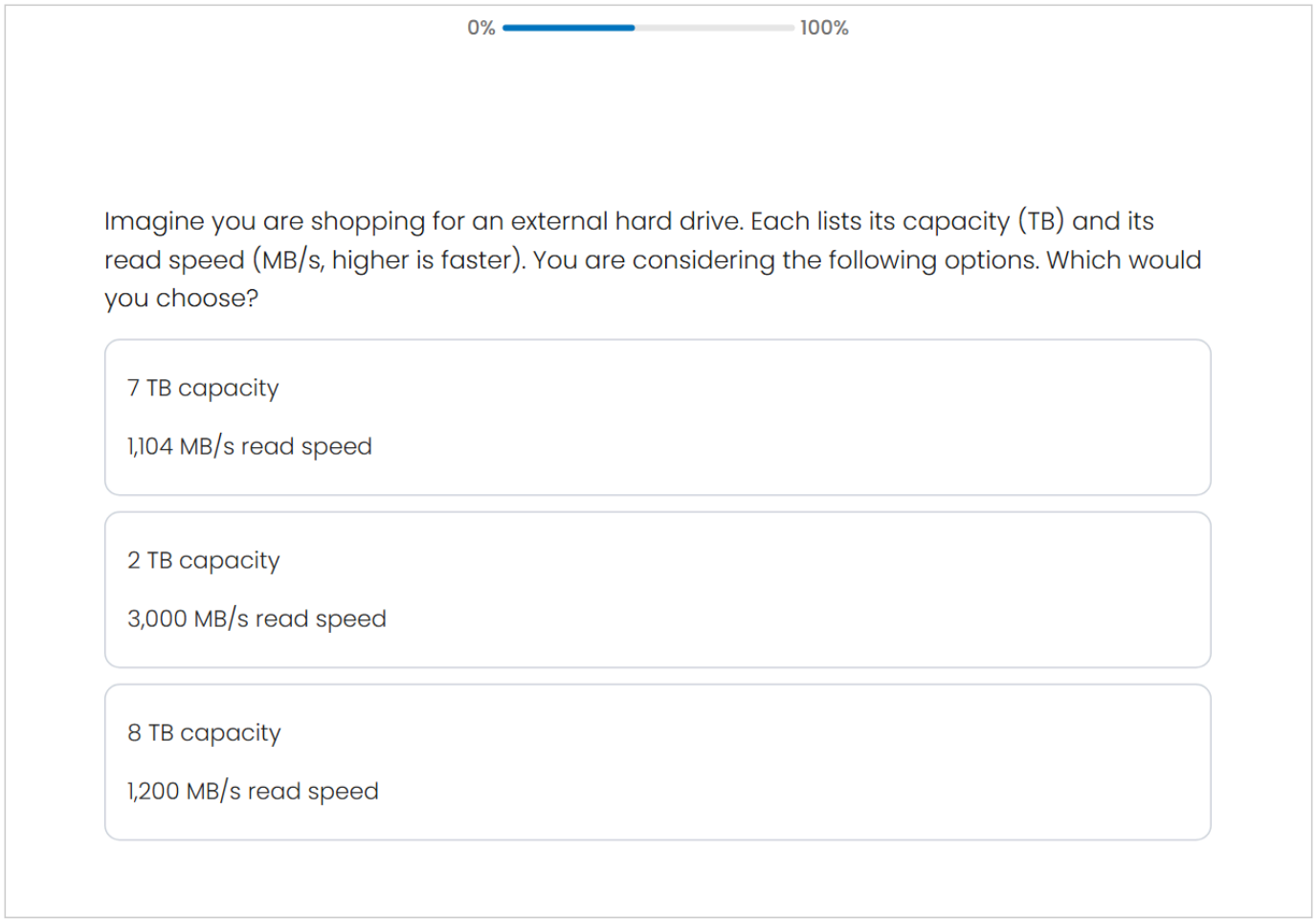
The compromise page: the two baseline options plus a more extreme third option, so one original becomes the middle choice. Category: water bottles; new-values tier. The values appear only as bars in the picture; the participant chooses by the option's letter. The picture is the same file the models receive.

Survey 4: price-free survey

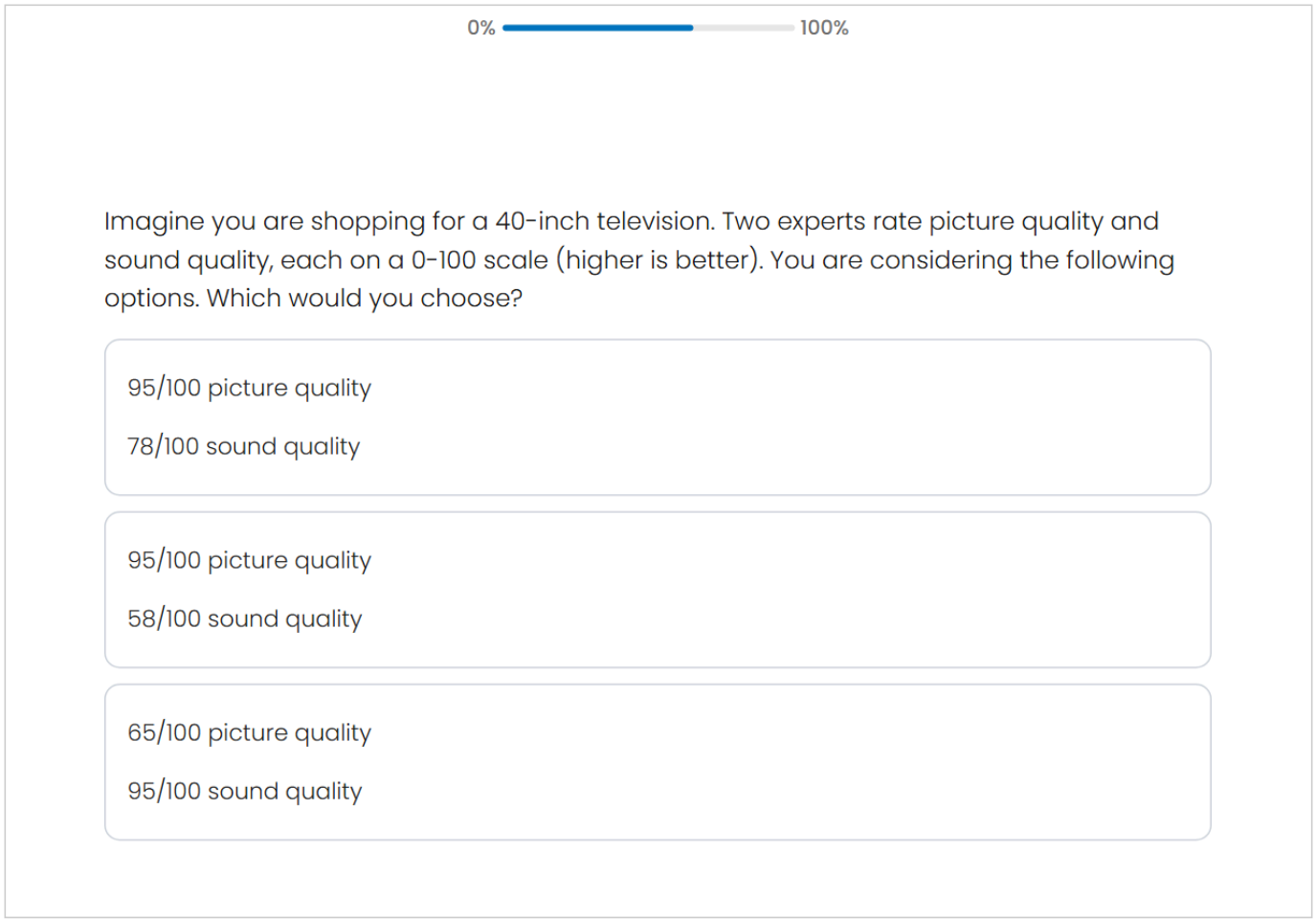
About 2,800 participants make three choices each among options described by two quality attributes and no price, across three categories. The other pages are identical to the words version.



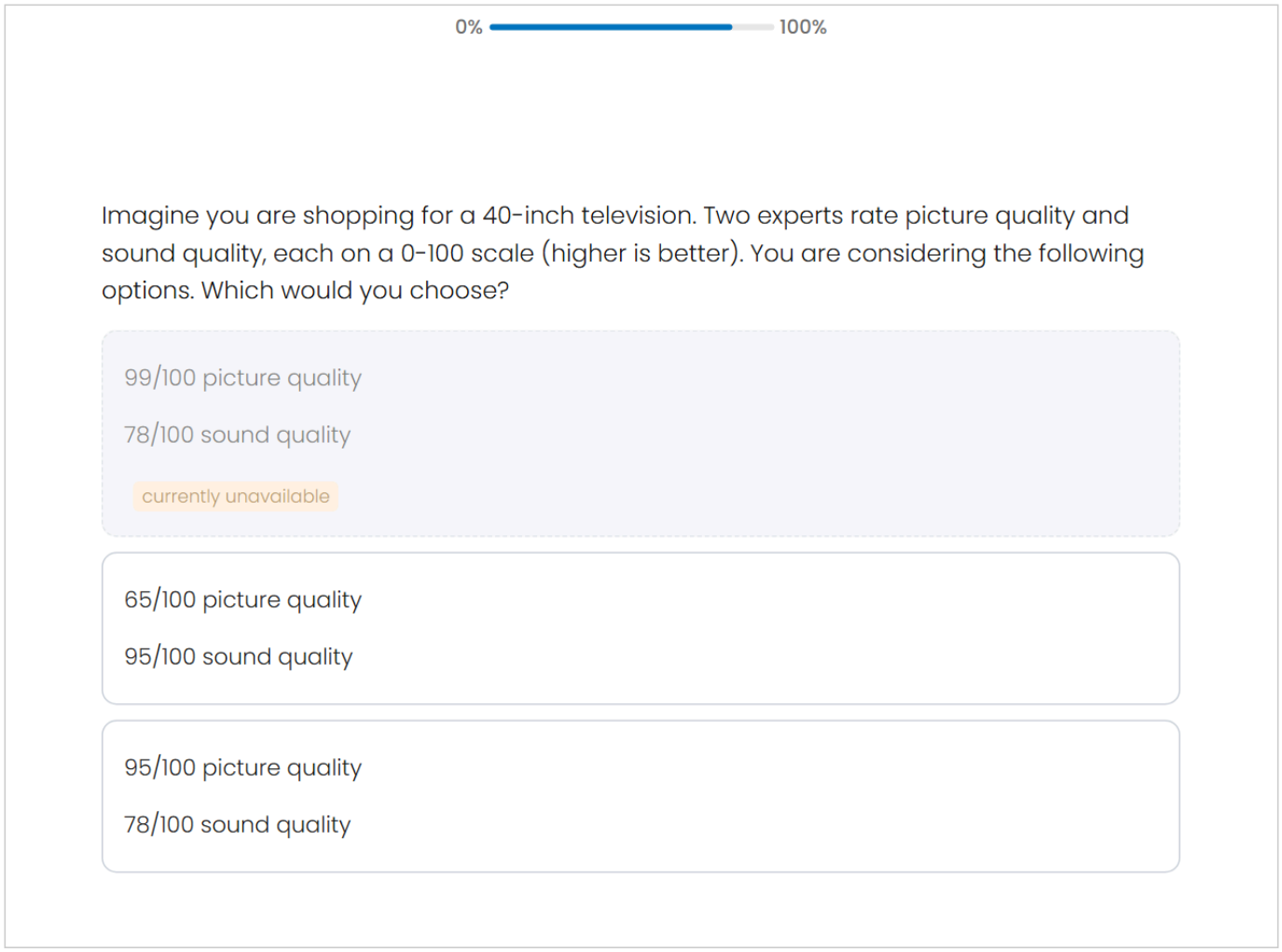
The two-option page, the baseline each effect is measured against. Category: restaurants. The options carry two quality attributes and no price.



An attraction page with a frequency decoy: a third option modestly worse than the target on both attributes. Category: external hard drives. The options carry two quality attributes and no price.

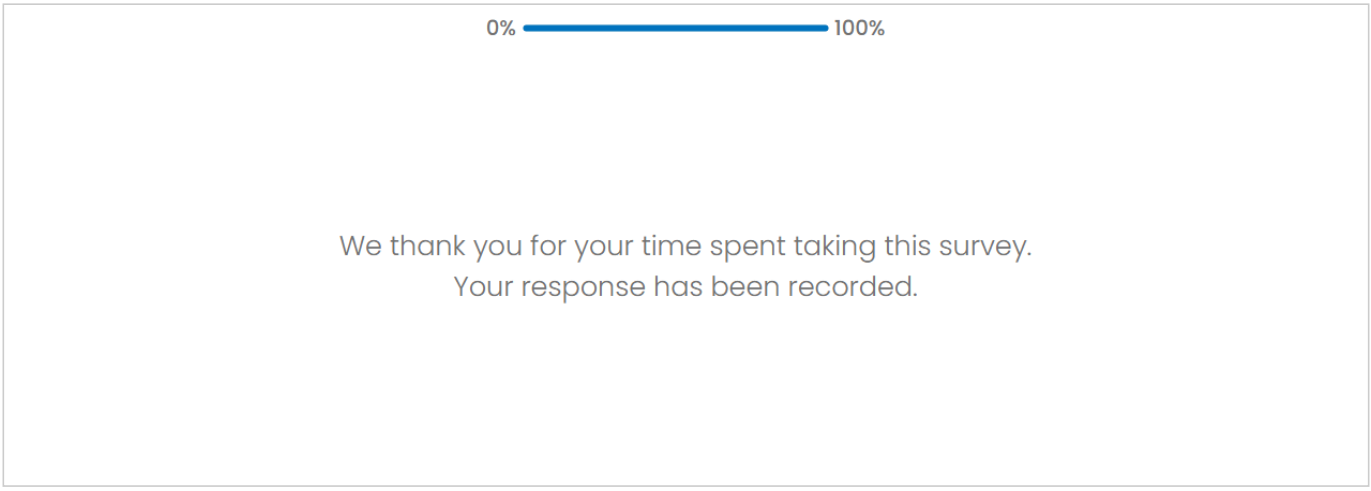


An attraction page with a range decoy: a third option far worse than the target on the attribute on which the target is weak. Category: televisions. The options carry two quality attributes and no price.

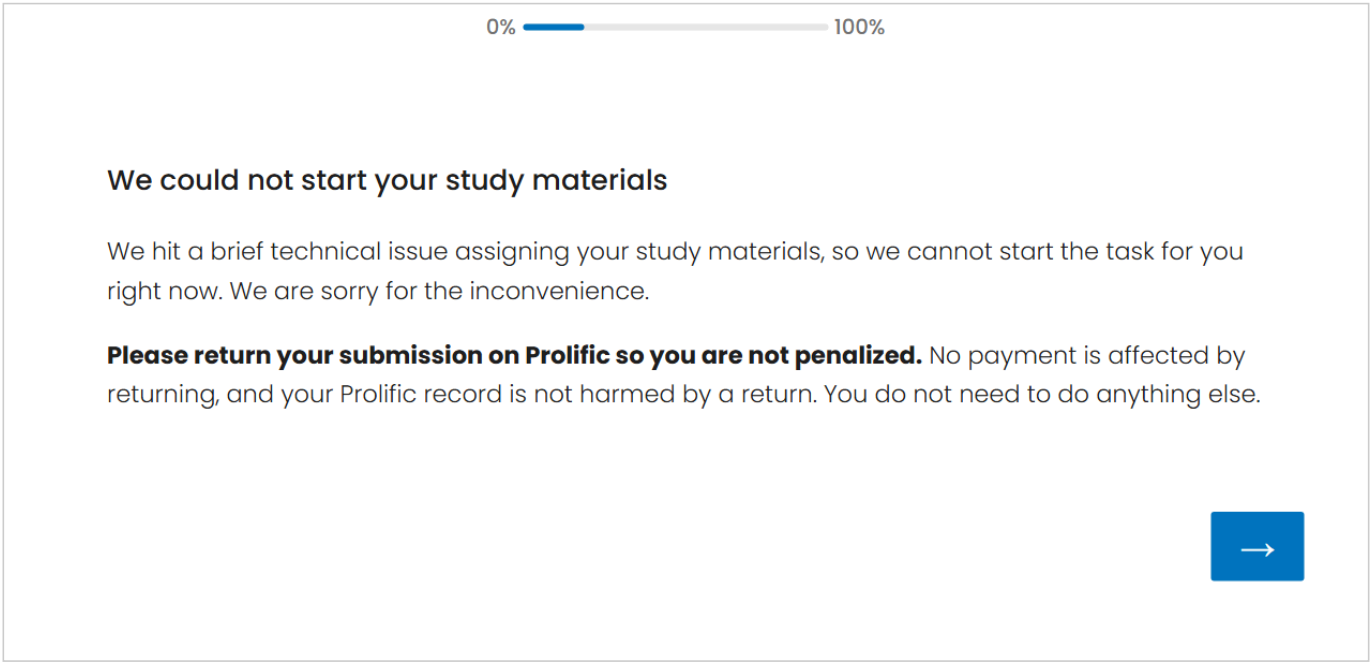


The phantom page: a third option better than the target on one attribute but marked currently unavailable, so it cannot be chosen. Category: televisions. The options carry two quality attributes and no price.

Pages shown only when a participant stops early



The end page after a participant declines consent (all five surveys). No choices are shown and no completion code is given.



Surveys 3 and 4 fetch the participant's pre-built script from a small assignment service after the attention check. If the service does not answer, this page is shown before any choice, and the survey then ends with the page above.